

CITY: PG 3
Commonwealth Table Tennis
Championship 2026 kicks off



BUSINESS: PG 10
HDFC Bank imposes ₹1L fine on MD,
CFO, group head in MSRDC case



FILM: PG 12
Shehnaaz shares why
Bollywood offers dried up



India summons
Ukraine envoy;
lodges protest over
killing of Indian

SIMONTINI BHATTACHARJEE

NEW DELHI: India called in Ukraine's Ambassador Oleksandr Polishchuk on Monday to lodge a strong protest after an Indian seafarer was killed in a strike on a merchant vessel in the Black Sea last week.

The Ministry of External Affairs said it had raised serious concern with the envoy and condemned the attack on commercial shipping in firm terms. The ship, MV Omorf, is reported to have been hit by Ukrainian drones during renewed fighting between Russia and Ukraine.

"Today, Ambassador of Ukraine to India, Oleksandr Polishchuk, was summoned to the Ministry of External Affairs in connection with the attack on the

Continued on P4

THE BILL INTRODUCED IN LOK SABHA AMID DIN

Parl deadlock may end as LS set to debate anti-paper leak Bill today

VINAY KUMAR

NEW DELHI: Parliament resumed on Monday after a week-long deadlock over the NEET-UG paper leak and police action against student protesters, with the government introducing a Bill to tighten the anti-paper leak law through stricter penalties, fast-track investigations and special courts. The opposition stalled proceedings, but according to sources, all parties have agreed to discuss the legislation on Tuesday.

Union Minister Jitendra Singh introduced the Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Amendment Bill, 2026 in the Lok Sabha amidst din, which seeks to significantly tighten penalties for those involved in government examination paper leaks.

The Bill proposes increasing the punishment for paper leak offences from the existing three to five years'



KEY POINTS

- » Opposition stalled debate, demanding government response on police action against protesting students
- » Rajya Sabha witnessed repeated adjournments amid protests over police action accountability
- » Speaker allotted six hours for debate, with scope for extension if needed
- » BILL MANDATES COMPLETION OF PAPER LEAK INVESTIGATIONS WITHIN TWO MONTHS

imprisonment to five to 10 years, while enhancing the maximum fine from Rs 10 lakh to Rs 50 lakh.

No discussion could take place on the Bill as the opposition refused to relent from its demand of seeking response from the government over

with no sign yet of ending the logjam.

The Upper House saw repeated adjournments as opposition ruckus demanding the accountability of Union Home Minister Amit Shah over police action against protesting students continued.

Continued on P4

JANTAR MANTAR POLICE ACTION

Mere agitation can't justify lathi charge': SC

'Right to peaceful protest guaranteed'

MPOST BUREAU

CLOSER LOOK

NEW DELHI: The Supreme Court on Monday said the constitutional right to peaceful and lawful protest cannot be curtailed merely because an agitation is taking place, observing that allegations of police excess during demonstrations must be independently examined. Hearing a batch of petitions arising from the July 20 student protest in Delhi over examination irregularities and the alleged NEET paper leak, the court also indicated the need for uniform police protocols across the country for handling public demonstrations. The bench led by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant, along with Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana, is scheduled to hear the matter further on Tuesday.

CJI Kant orally observed, "Right to peaceful, lawful

- » Bench sought independent examination of alleged police excesses
- » Court called for uniform police protocols during protests nationwide
- » Hearing on the batch of petitions will continue on Tuesday
- » Families of injured police personnel will also be heard

protest absolutely guaranteed under Constitution. So long as it is peaceful agitation, merely because there is agitation, there can't be [excess]... If there is excess committed, it should be independently examined. It's not only a case of Delhi. Uniformity in protocol required. Merely because agitation there, doesn't mean a lathi charge.

Continued on P4

Quick News

NITIN GADKARI TO SUE META, X, GOOGLE OVER DEEPFAKES ON E20

MUMBAI: The Bombay High Court on Monday allowed Union Minister Nitin Gadkari to file a civil suit against Meta Platforms, X Corp, Google LLC and unidentified persons over alleged defamatory posts, deepfakes and AI-generated content linking him and his family to financial gains from the Centre's E20 ethanol programme. Justice Abhay Ahuja granted permission after hearing Gadkari's leave petition under Clause XII of the Letters Patent, which is required when part of the cause of action falls outside the court's territorial jurisdiction.

Appearing for Gadkari, advocate Sandeep S. Ladda told the court that the disputed content was accessible to users in Mumbai and across Maharashtra through online platforms, while also being available elsewhere, making leave under Clause XII necessary. The court accepted the submissions and permitted the minister to institute the suit.

According to the proposed suit, unknown persons circulated false and AI-generated content portraying Gadkari as personally responsible for the ethanol blending programme

Continued on P4

BEVERAGE FIRMS ORDERED TO DROP 'ENERGY DRINK' LABEL

NEW DELHI: FSSAI has given beverage firms, including PepsiCo and Reliance Retail, 90 days to remove the "energy drink" label after rejecting industry requests for relief. Separately, it suspended Westend Agro Products' licence over alleged relabelling, altered manufacturing and expiry dates, and sale of misbranded food products, sources said.

See P10

NUMBER OF BILLIONAIRES GROWS 4-FOLD IN 5 YEARS

NEW DELHI: As many as 576 people reported gross total income of Rs 100 crore or more in income tax returns for AY 2025-26, up fourfold from 142 in AY 2021-22, Finance MoS Pankaj Chaudhary told Lok Sabha on Monday. He said there is no statutory definition of "billionaire" under tax laws.

See P9

CJP alleges breach of assurance, warns of fresh protest if FIRs not withdrawn

AIMAN FATIMA

NEW DELHI: Two days after calling off its 36-day nationwide agitation, the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) on Monday said it was still awaiting the Centre's promised written assurance on the withdrawal of FIRs and protection of protesters, alleging that students and volunteers were continuing to face



detention and arrests in states such as Bihar, West Bengal and Assam despite the government's commitment.

Launches 'saakshi' legal platform, Kapil Sibal announces Rs.1 crore support

ment. Warning that it would be "forced to resume its nationwide agitation

Continued on P4

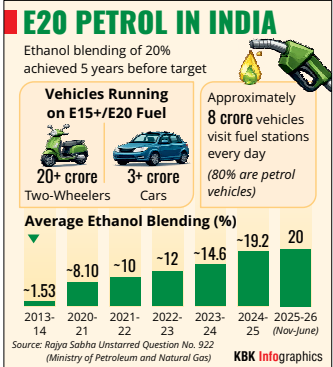
Govt says no study yet on how many vehicles suit E20 petrol

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The government has admitted it does not know what share of vehicles on Indian roads can fully handle E20 petrol, even as it continues to insist the fuel is safe to use.

Responding to a question in the Rajya Sabha on Monday, Minister of State for Petroleum and Natural Gas Suresh Gopi said the Ministry of Heavy Industries had confirmed that no such assessment of vehicle compatibility with E20, petrol blended with 20 per cent ethanol, has been carried out.

Despite this gap, Gopi said the ethanol-blended petrol programme was rolled out in phases and backed by scientific testing involving NITI Aayog, vehicle manufacturers, oil marketing companies, the Automotive Research Association of India, the Society of Indian Automobile Manufacturers, and the Indian Institute of Petroleum. He said trials looking at engine durability, drivability, corrosion resistance, material compatibility, emissions and fuel efficiency had found E20 safe for use, and that older vehicles showed no unusual wear or perfor-



mance issues because of the fuel.

The E20 rollout has faced pushback from opposition parties and consumer groups, who worry about its effect on older cars not built for such a high ethanol blend. They have asked whether all vehicles can truly run on E20, pointed to possible drops in mileage and higher upkeep costs, and demanded clarity on who bears responsibility if engines or fuel systems are damaged.

Gopi said E15-plus petrol has been sold widely for over three and a half years, and E19-E20 fuel for more than two and a half

Continued on P4

Gyaneshwari, Bindyarani lift India

Track and field athletes, boxers advance

S KANNAN

GLASGOW: India's campaign gathered momentum on Monday with weightlifters Gyaneshwari Yadav and Bindyarani Devi adding a silver and a bronze respectively, while the country's athletes, boxers and swimmers booked places in the finals and quarterfinals to keep medal hopes alive at the Commonwealth Games.

Gyaneshwari produced the performance of her career to finish second in the women's 53kg event, lifting a personal best total of 199kg through 88kg in snatch and 111kg in clean and jerk. The 23-year-old was locked in an intense battle with Nigeria's Onome Omolola Didih, who won gold with a Commonwealth and Commonwealth Games record total of 206kg after lifting 93kg in snatch and 113kg in clean and jerk.



TAKEAWAYS

- » M Sreesankar qualified directly for the men's long jump final with a first-attempt leap of 8.01m
- » Lokesh Sathyanathan also reached the long jump final after clearing 7.77m

The contest reached its peak in the clean and jerk, where Gyaneshwari briefly set a new Commonwealth Games record with her 111kg lift

before Didih responded with a title-winning 113kg effort. The Indian matched her personal best in snatch and improved her best marks in both clean and jerk and overall total.

The silver was India's fourth medal in weightlifting and fifth overall at the Games. It also capped an inspiring journey for Gyaneshwari, a former powerlifter whose father, an electrician, backed her sporting ambitions despite financial hardship. Inspired by Olympic silver medalist Mirabai Chanu, Gyaneshwari had set out to achieve personal bests in Glasgow and returned with both improved numbers and a Commonwealth Games silver.

India added another podium finish later in the evening when Bindyarani Devi claimed bronze in the women's 58kg category. The 2022 Birmingham Commonwealth Games silver

Continued on P4

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IB OFFICER MURDER CASE

Police seek death penalty for Tahir Hussain, others

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Delhi Police urged a court here on Monday to sentence former AAP councillor Tahir Hussain and four others to death in the murder case of IB officer Ankit Sharma during the 2020 Delhi riots, saying "they fell to the level of being animals" while relentlessly assaulting him.

The submissions were made before Additional Sessions Judge Praveen Singh who was also informed that Sharma was abducted, relentlessly assaulted and then killed by convicted persons.

The court reserved its order for July 31 after hearing arguments from both prosecution and defence counsels of all five convicts.

Special public prosecutor Madhukar Pandey submitted that Sharma was brutally killed and was not shown any mercy by the convicts, so they should not be given any leniency.

"Those who are asking for mercy today should have shown mercy themselves. No mercy was shown from anyone's side. No one even took Ankit to the hospital. They are asking for mercy after committing such a brutal murder," Pandey said.

They kept torturing him even after he died, he said.

"Ankit Sharma was abducted and relentlessly assaulted before he was killed. A total of 51 wounds were found on his body; 18 of those were inflicted with sharp weapons.

"The nature of the weapons used shows the intent and diabolical nature of the crime. They fell to the level of being animals. Even after the victim died, they continued the assault," he said.

Pandey also asserted that the nature of the crime was



Special public prosecutor Pandey submitted that Sharma was brutally killed and was not shown any mercy by the convicts

heinous and brutal, and the convicts should be handed the death sentence.

"This was a cold-blooded murder. These people turned into butchers during the crime. There was not even a single cloth except underwear on Sharma's body. These people should be kept behind bars, (and) given the death sentence," he said.

"The manner of this killing is not to be seen in isolation, but with the 53 people killed in the riots. So, the context also became relevant, the context in which the riots took place," he added. It was also submitted that the deceased never provoked anyone, but the convicts themselves got involved in the murder.

"My humble submission is that the commission of this offence, and the conduct of the convicts, was such that no leniency should be shown to the convicts. There was no provocation in this case. They deliberately got involved in a

cold-blooded murder. In this case, the balance of sentencing policy should be shifted towards the death sentence," Pandey said.

"Those who did not show mercy to people during the riots should not be entitled to seek mercy," he added.

Representing Hussain, advocates Rajiv Mohan and Tara Narula opposed the state's contention and argued that no specific role had been attributed to their client and it should also be considered that out of the 11 accused, six were acquitted in the case.

"Every convicted person should not be given the death sentence. Aggravating circumstances should be considered first and then the mitigating circumstances. Of conviction, out of the 11 accused, six have been acquitted," advocate Mohan said.

He contended that the death penalty is only given in the rarest of rare cases, and in this case, the judgement only mentions the presence of a mob at the crime scene, but not about the specific role of the convicts.

"The punishment of death cannot be determined merely based on the injuries sustained. His (Hussain) conduct was good in jail during custody. The court had recorded the statements of 91 witnesses, after which only five out of the 11 accused were convicted by the court," he said.

Hussain's counsel also said that throughout the trial, no evidence of criminal conspiracy (under IPC Section 120B) was presented before the court.

The court convicted Hussain and four others on July 13 for the murder of IB staffer Ankit Sharma during the 2020 Delhi riots, holding they were part of an armed mob that carried out a fatal assault.

Centre tells High Court plea on surveillance of Jantar Mantar NEET protest 'infructuous'

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Central government on Monday told the Delhi High Court that the PIL alleging intrusive surveillance of peaceful protesters at the CJP-led protest against the NEET paper leak at Jantar Mantar was infructuous.

A bench of Chief Justice D K Upadhyaya and Justice Tejas Karia asked the petitioner to "let things cool down further" and raise the issue in a subsequent petition that is "general" in nature, and not confined to a specific protest.

The PIL was filed by former Jawaharlal Nehru University Students' Union (JNUSU) president Aishe Ghosh, Ghosh's senior counsel, however, said, the prayers in the PIL were "still alive", as it concerned surveillance of protesters in the absence of a legal framework.

"You better file a petition where we can examine the provisions. This petition, as



we understood, was confined to a particular protest. We are permitting you to file a petition which is general in nature. This insistence on your part (to press the present PIL)...Things have cooled down. Let them cool down further," the bench observed. "Why are you pressing it now? In a subsequent petition, you can make a prayer for guidelines," it asked.

The petitioner's senior counsel submitted that certain prayers in the PIL were still relevant, such as a direction to the authorities to permanently destroy all personal data collected through the surveillance, especially since the Centre has assured that no action would

'The petitioner has in her possession photographs depicting the permanent surveillance tower and continuous photography and videography undertaken by police personnel...'

be taken against the protesters.

The court said it will hear the matter on Tuesday.

Earlier, the petitioner's senior counsel asserted that the right to privacy is not surrendered in public spaces, raised concerns over the presence of police personnel in civil dress for video-recording and the alleged use of facial recognition technology by the police to identify protesters.

Solicitor General Tushar Mehta submitted that video-recording of the protest against NEET paper leak was in "legitimate state interest" and any objection to it was ironic.

Mehta said even influencers and other people from social

media were making videos and taking interviews at the site, and the CJP itself has asked the protesters to "videograph everything".

The PIL, filed through lawyer Subhash Chandran K R, has sought a declaration that "continuous and intrusive mass surveillance" of peaceful protesters is constitutionally impermissible, disproportionate and cannot be justified under the guise of maintaining public order or national security.

It has sought a direction to authorities to forthwith suspend the mass photography, videography and surveillance at Jantar Mantar until there is a "proximate, real and imminent

threat to public order", justifying such measures.

"The petitioner has in her possession photographs depicting the permanent surveillance tower and the continuous photography and videography undertaken by police personnel, which demonstrate the pervasive and intrusive nature of the surveillance being carried out by the respondents," the plea has said.

"The surveillance is indiscriminate in nature, extending to every individual present at the protest site irrespective of any suspicion of unlawful conduct and encompassing not merely the public acts of protest but also the ordinary incidents of daily life, including eating, resting, seeking medical assistance and other personal activities," the plea has said.

The Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) called off their 36-day protests on July 25 after Dharmendra Pradhan tendered his resignation as the

Traffic cop performs CPR, rushes advocate to hospital after collapse

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: After an advocate collapsed from a suspected cardiac emergency while riding a motorcycle at the ITO intersection on Monday here, a traffic policeman administered cardiopulmonary resuscitation (CPR) and rushed him to the hospital, an officer said.

The incident occurred at 11:55 am when Traffic Inspector Gopal of Kamla Market circle was regulating traffic at A-Point at the ITO in Central Delhi. The officer noticed the motorcyclist, identified as Advocate Nameet, suddenly lose control of his vehicle and collapse on the road while travelling from the IP Estate side towards ITO, police said.

According to the officer, the



inspector immediately reached the scene, removed the victim's helmet and administered CPR, a life-saving emergency procedure performed when someone is breathing or heartbeat stops, combining chest compressions and rescue breaths to keep blood and oxygen moving through the body.

"Preliminary assessment suggested the prevailing extreme heat with high humidity might have aggravated the

medical emergency, though the exact cause is yet to be confirmed," the officer said.

Police said traffic congestion in the area could have delayed medical assistance; therefore, the traffic inspector transported the advocate to Lok Nayak Jai Prakash (LNJP) Hospital in an official police vehicle instead of waiting for an ambulance.

Police said the victim was admitted to the hospital within minutes of the incident and doctors are carrying out further medical examination to ascertain the exact cause of the medical emergency.

The Delhi Police said the traffic policeman's prompt response ensured the victim received medical attention during the crucial time.

Bishnoi-Hashim Baba gang aide held: Police

PRAJYOT DEOGHARE

NEW DELHI: The Delhi Police's Special Cell has arrested a proclaimed offender allegedly linked to the Lawrence Bishnoi-Hashim Baba gang in connection with the murder of businessman Nadir Shah in Greater Kailash-I, officials said on Monday. The accused, Saddam Hussain alias Sonu, a resident of Jafraabad in Delhi, had been absconding since September 2024. Police said his arrest takes the total number of accused held in the case to 17.

Acting on a tip-off, the Special Cells' NDR team arrested Saddam from Amroha in Uttar Pradesh on July 20. Based on his disclosure, police later recovered a pistol and three live cartridges from Shastri Park in Delhi. According to investigators, Saddam pro-

Nadir Shah, a gym owner, was shot dead outside his establishment in GK-I

vided logistical support to the shooters and other members of the Lawrence Bishnoi-Hashim Baba gang. He is also accused of helping conceal the weapons used in the murder and remaining on the run after the arrest of his associates.

Nadir Shah, a gym owner, was shot dead outside his Greater Kailash-I establishment on September 12, 2024. Police said he was allegedly targeted for refusing extortion demands made by the gang. Saddam had previously been arrested in 2013 and 2018 in separate cases.

NGT asks authorities to create biofencing, other restorative measures for Delhi pond

NEW DELHI: The National Green Tribunal (NGT) on Monday directed authorities to create bio-fencing by planting shrubs and trees as a restorative measure for a pond in the Kanganheri village in southwest Delhi's Kapashera.

The green body was hearing an execution application seeking implementation of the tribunal's September 2024 directions to "take appropriate steps for restoration of the pond to its original size and shape." The directions were passed in a matter seeking restoration of the encroached and polluted water body.

In its order on Monday, a bench of judicial member Justice Arun Kumar Tyagi and expert member A Senthil Vel noted that the Irrigation and Flood Control (I&FC) Depart-

Pond needs to be periodically cleaned, the authorities concerned have to ensure that solid waste is not dumped in the water

ment and the district magistrate of southwest district had filed status reports.

Noting the reports, it said that construction of a pucca permanent boundary wall to restore the pond could result in the obstruction of rainwater or surface run-off water flow from the catchment area to the pond, leading to its degradation and stagnation.

"Therefore, the option of creation of bio-fencing by way of plantation of an appropriate number of shrubs and trees on the periphery needs to be looked into, particularly so as the same will also add to the

aesthetic look and contribute to control of air pollution."

"Further, the pond needs to be periodically cleaned, and the authorities concerned have to ensure that solid waste is not dumped in the water or the periphery of the pond. For this purpose, appropriate display boards with appropriate warnings may be installed at the appropriate places," the tribunal said. It directed the DM to involve the deputy conservator of forests (DCF) concerned for carrying out the requisite plantation during the ongoing monsoon season.

"Admittedly, there are

encroachments on the area of the pond and in the status reports, such encroachments have also been specifically mentioned. We clarify for the sake of abundant caution that mere filing of the present application and taking of cognisance of the same by this tribunal does not by itself warrant any demolition without following due course of law," the bench said.

The tribunal directed the Delhi government to identify all encroachments and initiate eviction proceedings in accordance with the law, subject to court orders. It also sought fresh status reports on preventing untreated sewage discharge, removing solid waste from the pond and its periphery, and listed the matter for September 8. **MPOST**

HOLDS TORCHLIGHT PROCESSION

JNUSU celebrates Pradhan's resignation, vows to intensify edu reform movement

ANAMTA FATIMA

NEW DELHI: The Jawaharlal Nehru University Students' Union (JNUSU) organised a Mashal Julos (torchlight procession), describing the resignation of former Union Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan as "a victory for the student youth movement" while asserting that the agitation for education reforms would continue.

The march began at 9 p.m. from Barak Hostel and concluded at the university's Main Gate, drawing participation from students and activists. In posters released ahead of the event, the students' union termed the resignation a milestone in the ongoing movement but declared that "the fight continues".

Besides celebrating what it



described as a major achievement, the procession highlighted a series of unresolved demands. Protesters reiterated their call for the scrapping of the National Testing Agency (NTA) and the National Education Policy (NEP), alleging that recent controversies surrounding entrance examinations had exposed systemic shortcomings in the country's

higher education framework.

The demonstration also demanded the immediate removal of the police outpost located near JNU's North Gate, with the students' union alleging that its presence represented excessive policing on the campus.

Participants further condemned what they described as the "unlawful and arbitrary

incarceration" of several student activists and political workers. The march sought the release of individuals including former JNUSU president Dhananjay and student leaders and activists associated with organisations such as the All India Students' Association (AISA) and the Students' Federation of India (SFI).

The torchlight procession comes a day after Pradhan stepped down as Union Education Minister following weeks of student-led protests over examination-related issues. While protesters hailed the resignation as a significant political victory, JNUSU leaders maintained that their movement would continue until their broader demands on education policy, examination reforms and campus autonomy are addressed.

Social media jewellery fraud accused caught: Cops

NEW DELHI: Delhi Police have arrested a 26-year-old man for allegedly duping a woman of more than Rs 1.16 lakh in an online jewellery scam through a fake social media advertisement.

The accused, Ankit Thakur, a resident of Palwal in Haryana, was arrested after investigators traced the money trail. Police recovered a mobile phone and SIM card allegedly used in the fraud.

According to police, the woman transferred the money through multiple UPI transactions on February 14 after being assured the jewellery would be delivered. The jewellery was never delivered. Police alleged Thakur received around 10 per cent of the cheated amount, while efforts are underway to arrest his associate and identify other members of the cyber fraud syndicate. **MPOST**

THYAGRAJ STADIUM

Commonwealth Table Tennis Championship 2026 kicks off

AIMAN FATIMA

NEW DELHI: Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Monday inaugurated the 22nd Commonwealth Table Tennis Championship 2026 at Thyagraj Stadium, marking the start of the week-long international tournament that will continue till August 2. The championship has brought together players from 25 Commonwealth member countries, with free entry for spectators.

Welcoming athletes, coaches and official delegations, Gupta said it was a matter of pride for Delhi to host the prestigious tournament and reaffirmed the Capital's readiness to stage major international sporting events.

Addressing the gathering, the Chief Minister said, "Sports are not just about competition, they are a powerful force for connecting countries and cultures." She added that such events inspire young people to embrace discipline, dedication



and healthy competition while strengthening global friendship and cultural exchange.

Gupta formally declared the championship open after unveiling the official trophy. The inauguration also featured the athletes' oath, where players pledged to uphold sportsmanship and fair play, followed by a ceremonial first stroke played by the Chief Minister with a

table tennis racket. The opening ceremony began with the lighting of the ceremonial lamp and a rendition of Vande Mataram, followed by the Parade of Nations and cultural performances, including Colour of India, Shiv Tandav and a sitar-symphony jugalbandi, showcasing India's cultural heritage. Highlighting the country's

TAKEAWAYS

- » Gupta formally declared the championship open after unveiling the official trophy
- » The inauguration also featured the athletes' oath, where players pledged to uphold sportsmanship, fair play
- » Followed by a ceremonial first stroke played by the Chief Minister with a table tennis racket

sporting progress, Gupta said, "Under the leadership of Prime Minister Narendra Modi, India is achieving new milestones in sports through world-class infrastructure, modern facilities and its growing capability to host international events." She added that the Delhi Government is committed to promoting sports by strengthening infrastructure and creating bet-

ter opportunities for young athletes.

Education and Sports Minister Ashish Sood said the championship was more than a sporting contest. "Sporting events are not merely competitions but also platforms for cultural exchange," he said, adding that the tournament would strengthen friendship and sportsmanship among Commonwealth nations.

He also emphasised the importance of sports in education, saying, "Education and sports complement each other. While classrooms provide knowledge, sports teach teamwork, discipline, leadership, patience and perseverance."

The championship features participants from countries including India, Australia, England, Malaysia, Singapore, South Africa, Sri Lanka, New Zealand and Canada, among others. Spectators can attend all matches free of cost until the tournament concludes on August 2.

Delhi govt to hike funds for Kanwar camps to Rs 15 lakh



OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Delhi government has decided to hike financial assistance for large Kanwar camps from the current Rs 11 lakh to Rs 15 lakh and to continue free electricity up to 1,200 units, Chief Minister Rekha Gupta said on Monday.

The government is set to take a major decision to make Kanwar Yatra this year more organised, safe, and convenient for the devotees, she said in a Delhi CMO statement.

The hike in monetary help to kanwar samitis has been announced keeping in view the rising number of pilgrims, inflation and the increasing cost of running Kanwar camps, the government said.

The chief minister announced Rs 15 lakh for camps spread over more than 20,000 square feet and operating for 6 to 12 days.

Assistance for camps of the same size operating for 3 to 5 days will be up from Rs 6 lakh to Rs 9 lakh. Camps spread over 15,001 to 20,000 square feet will receive Rs 8 lakh instead of Rs 4 lakh for a duration of 3 to 5 days, while assistance for camps operating for 6 to 12 days will increase from Rs 7 lakh to Rs 9 lakh.

For camps between 10,001 and 15,000 square feet, the assistance will be raised from Rs 4 lakh to Rs 6 lakh for 3 to 5 days, and from Rs 7 lakh to Rs 8 lakh for 6 to 12 days.

MCD directs extensive medical civic, sanitation arrangements

ANAMTA FATIMA

NEW DELHI: The Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) has directed all its zonal offices to complete civic and public health arrangements ahead of the Kanwar Yatra 2026, with camps across the Capital set to become operational from July 30, the first day of the Shravana month, until Shivratri on August 11.

The directions were issued through an office memorandum by Additional Commissioner (DEMS) Arun K. Mishra following a high-level meeting chaired by Delhi Minister for Law and Justice, Labour, Employment and Development Reforms. Senior officials from the MCD, Revenue Department, Delhi Jal Board, Delhi Urban Shelter Improvement Board and Delhi Police attended the meeting.

According to the memorandum, Kanwar camps will primarily be established at 308 existing locations, with additional sites to be set up wherever required. The MCD

has instructed all Deputy Commissioners of its zones to coordinate with the respective District Magistrates, who have been designated as nodal officers for issuing no-objection certificates and overseeing arrangements.

The civic body has asked its zonal offices to remove encroachments from all camp sites before the yatra begins and ensure deep cleaning, scavenging and removal of vegetation. Sanitation services are to be maintained round the clock through deployment of workers and machinery in three shifts.

The memorandum also directs authorities to undertake extensive fumigation before and during the pilgrimage and implement preventive measures against water-borne and vector-borne diseases.

The MCD has also directed the closure of unauthorised meat shops along Kanwar routes and around camps, while mobile dispensaries will provide medical assistance at larger camps.

308 in 2025.

Kanwar samitis will continue to receive free electricity of up to 1,200 units, the government said. Power discoms BSES and TPDDL will ensure timely electricity connections and complete all required formalities before the Yatra begins, it said.

The chief minister said the advance instalment and the final instalment of the grant will be released directly by the office of the district magistrate.

Delhiite stages protest atop tree

NEW DELHI: A 51-year-old man allegedly attempted to end his life after climbing a tree in central Delhi on Monday, claiming an NGO managing Delhi Urban Shelter Improvement Board (DUSIB) shelter homes had not paid his dues. Police and Delhi Fire Services personnel persuaded him to climb down safely. He was counselled, while officials said his grievance would be examined in accordance with the law. **MPOST**



DDA launches native forest restoration across 4 Delhi Ridge stretches

SHIVANGI SHUKLA

NEW DELHI: The Delhi Development Authority (DDA), under the guidance of Lieutenant Governor Sardar Taranjit Singh Sandhu, has launched Phase I of an ecological restoration project across nearly 120 hectares of the Delhi Ridge, using a scientifically designed grid-based, multi-tier plantation model with indigenous tree and shrub species. The initiative aims to restore the Ridge's native forest ecosystem rather than simply increasing green cover.

The restoration is being carried out across the South Central Ridge, Central Ridge, Kamla Nehru Ridge and Nanakpura Ridge in accordance with the approved Working Plan for the Delhi Ridge. It forms part of the 70 Lakh Plantation Mission launched by Union Home and Cooperation Minister Amit Shah under the 'Ek Ped Maa Ke Naam' campaign on July 7, 2026.

During his visit to the Ridge in May, the Lieutenant Governor reviewed its ecological condition and directed the DDA to undertake scientific restoration by removing invasive vegetation, replacing it with native species and ensuring sustained post-plantation maintenance.

Under Phase I, the DDA plans to remove around 16,240 invasive trees and shrubs and plant nearly one lakh indigenous trees along with 81,700 native shrubs. The objective is to restore the original structure, composition and ecological functions of Delhi's Ridge forests. A key feature of the project is its grid-based planta-

“Restoration is being carried out across the South Central Ridge, Kamla Nehru Ridge, Nanakpura Ridge & Central Ridge”

tion system, under which each plantation grid will comprise five native trees and four native shrubs planted at scientifically determined spacing to promote optimum canopy development, healthy root growth, adequate sunlight penetration and efficient use of resources. Designated ficus clusters will also be created at regular intervals to improve long-term ecological stability, while the multi-tier plantation model will recreate natural forest layers through canopy trees, middle-storey vegetation, understorey shrubs and ground vegetation.

As part of the plantation season, which began in the first week of July and will continue until mid-September, the DDA has planted 8,29,313 saplings across Delhi, including 35,570 trees and 7,93,743 shrubs. In the Ridge alone, 27,062 saplings, comprising 12,506 trees and 14,556 shrubs, have already been planted.

The programme also seeks to encourage public participation through partnerships with Resident Welfare Associations, educational institutions, religious organisations, corporate bodies and volunteer groups to help conserve Delhi's native forests and strengthen the Capital's environmental resilience.

'To minimise inconvenience, water tankers would be made available on request': DJB

The exercise is part of efforts to strengthen the city's water supply infrastructure.

The disruption will affect the command areas of Raja Garden, Ramesh Nagar, Khyala, Rani Bagh, Moti Nagar, Sharda

Puri, Tagore Garden, Tihar Village, Tilak Nagar, Varun Niketan, Rajouri Garden, Karam Pura, Saraswati Garden, Hari Nagar, Mansarovar Garden, Vishnu Garden, Subhash Nagar, parts of Uttam Nagar and Mohan Garden, Ganesh Nagar, Krishna Puri, JJ Colony Khyala, Ravi Nagar, Chand Nagar, and adjoining localities. The water utility has advised residents of the affected areas to store adequate water in advance to meet their daily requirements during the shutdown period.

To minimise inconvenience, the DJB said water tankers would be made available on request. Residents can contact the Central Control Room at 1916, 23527679, 23538495, or 23634469. Tankers can also be requested through the Punjabi Bagh office at 25223658, Shivaji Enclave at 25193140 or 25174140, and Paschim Vihar at 25281197.

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DJB expressed regret for the inconvenience and urged residents to cooperate during the maintenance work, aimed at improving water supply reliability across West Delhi. **MPOST**

MCD demolishes illegal structures, seals 11

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) on Monday intensified its crackdown on unauthorised construction and the misuse of residential properties by carrying out demolition and sealing drives across the Karol Bagh Zone.

The enforcement action, undertaken by the Building Department under the provisions of the Delhi Municipal Corporation Act and applicable building by-laws, targeted illegal structural additions in

Punjabi Bagh and residential properties being used for commercial purposes in parts of Karol Bagh.

In Punjabi Bagh, civic officials demolished unauthorised reinforced concrete (RCC) roof slab panels at the ground floor level and removed illegally constructed walls and columns on the first floor. Reinforcement bars were cut using gas cutters as part of the operation. The demolition was carried out with assistance from the local police and the MCD demolition squad.

Separately, the civic body

launched a sealing drive in East Patel Nagar, West Patel Nagar, South Patel Nagar and Ranjeet Nagar against the unauthorised commercial use of residential properties.

According to the MCD, 11 properties were sealed at multiple access points for violating land-use and building regulations.

The action covered basement and ground-floor premises where commercial establishments, including libraries, were found operating from residential buildings in violation of prescribed norms.

The Corporation said the drive forms part of its ongoing efforts to enforce sanctioned building plans and ensure compliance with land-use regulations across the Capital.

Appealing to residents to follow approved building and land-use norms, the MCD warned that violations of the Delhi Municipal Corporation Act and related regulations would invite strict action, including demolition of unauthorised structures and sealing of premises wherever necessary.

AAP to hold meet on E20

NEW DELHI: AAP national convener Arvind Kejriwal on Monday announced that the party will hold a 'National Town Hall Against E20' at the Constitution Club of India on August 1 to bring together stakeholders and press the Centre to withdraw E20 petrol.

Addressing a press conference, Kejriwal urged people to participate in large numbers, saying experts and vehicle owners affected by E20 fuel would discuss ways to build pressure on the Centre. AAP's online petition seeking to make E20 fuel optional has garnered nearly two lakh signatures. Kejriwal said he would submit it to PM Modi after the meet. He invited people to join virtually and reiterated his demand for lower-priced ethanol-blended petrol. **MPOST**

'Focus on making Delhi women's panel more accessible, proactive'

NEW DELHI: Making the Delhi Commission for Women (DCW) more accessible to complainants, strengthening the women's helpline and taking suo motu cognisance of cases, wherever required, will be among the priorities of its newly-appointed chairperson Lata Gupta.

Gupta said the DCW would focus on making it easier for women to approach the body, and ensure that complaints do not remain confined to files.

"My priority is to ensure that any woman seeking justice can reach the commission without difficulty and have confidence that her complaint will be addressed," she said.

Gupta said, the commission would actively pursue the reso-

lution of complaints and, where required, take suo motu cognisance of issues affecting women instead of waiting for formal complaints.

Gupta further said she is open to seeking suggestions from former DCW chairpersons, women leaders, legal experts and others to strengthen the functioning of the commission.

She also stressed the need to strengthen the women's helpline, saying it was important to provide immediate assistance to women facing distress, including those living in Delhi's rural areas.

"A strong helpline will enable women to register complaints from wherever they are and ensure the commission can

act on them promptly," she said.

Asked about allegations that women's commissions often act selectively depending on the political affiliation of those involved, Gupta said the commission was not a political platform and would deal with every complaint impartially.

"For me, a victim is a victim. The commission's role is to ensure she receives timely justice, guidance and all possible assistance under the law, irrespective of who the complaint is against," she said.

After remaining vacant for over two years, the DCW has been reconstituted with BJP leader Lata Gupta as chairperson. The government also reconstituted the Delhi Minorities Commission. **PII**

PUSHES SCIENTIFIC WASTE PROCESSING

L-G reviews waste mgmt, monsoon preps, air pollution plans

SHIVANGI SHUKLA

NEW DELHI: Delhi Lieutenant Governor Taranjit Singh Sandhu on Monday chaired a review meeting of the Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD), taking stock of key civic priorities across the Capital, including solid waste management, garbage disposal, measures to prevent waterlogging, drain cleaning and preparedness against vector-borne diseases.

Reviewing the remediation of legacy waste at Delhi's

landfill sites, the L-G appreciated the progress made by the MCD but reiterated his earlier direction that all fresh waste reaching the sites must be scientifically processed simultaneously to prevent further accumulation. He cautioned that the gains achieved through remediation would be undermined if incoming waste continued to pile up and directed officials to establish a robust monitoring mechanism to ensure daily waste processing keeps pace with daily inflow. Expressing concern over



the city's waste management, the L-G noted that around 50 per cent of waste is still not segregated at source and nearly

“Citing success of Indore Municipal Corporation, he directed officials to examine feasibility of implementing the Indore model”

half of the waste generated each day continues to be dumped at landfill sites. Citing the success of the Indore Municipal

Corporation, he directed officials to examine the feasibility of implementing the Indore model as a pilot project in one MCD zone.

The meeting also reviewed measures to prevent vector-borne diseases, particularly dengue and malaria, during the monsoon. Officials discussed issues related to traffic congestion at toll plazas and the implementation of the PM-UDAY scheme.

Looking ahead to winter, the L-G directed officials to prepare a comprehensive

action plan to curb air pollution, with particular emphasis on resurfacing roads across the Capital. He also ordered a dedicated road safety audit of MCD roads to identify and address safety concerns.

Concluding the meeting, the L-G stressed that every MCD officer must remain vigilant, proactive and accountable in delivering efficient civic services, saying that a cleaner, safer and more resilient Delhi can only be achieved through timely execution and a strong sense of responsibility.

MISRI ON OFFICIAL VISIT TO BEIJING

FS Misri holds talks with China's Vice FM Haiyan in Beijing

BEIJING: Foreign Secretary Vikram Misri met China's Vice Foreign Minister Hua Chunying here on Monday and discussed the entire gamut of the bilateral relations.

Misri, who is currently on an official visit to Beijing, also met Sun Haiyan, Vice Minister of the International Department of the Central Committee of the Communist Party of China (CPC).

Misri and Hua "reviewed the entire gamut of bilateral relations and discussed means of advancing the vision of the two leaders that India and China are partners and development opportunities for each other, including through mutually beneficial outcomes across trade and economic ties, culture, and people-to-people exchanges," the Indian Embassy in Beijing said in a post on X.



Foreign Secretary Vikram Misri holds talks with Sun Haiyan, Vice Minister of the International Department of the Central Committee of the Communist Party of China, during his official visit to China, in Beijing

"Both sides acknowledged the importance of maintaining peace and tranquillity in the India-China border areas," it added.

Earlier, Misri met Sun and "discussed ways to deepen

implementation of the guidance of the leaders for bilateral relations, including addressing issues of priority to both sides and by promoting political, people-to-people, academic and think-tank exchanges," the

Highlights

- » Misri and Hua "reviewed the entire gamut of bilateral relations and discussed means of advancing the vision of the two leaders that India and China are partners and development opportunities for each other"
- » Misri also met Hong Liang, Deputy Secretary General of the 14th National Committee of the Chinese People's Political Consultative Conference (CPPCC).

Embassy said.

Misri also met Hong Liang, Deputy Secretary General of the 14th National Committee of the Chinese People's Political Consultative Conference (CPPCC).

Hong was previously the Director General of the boundary department of the Chinese Foreign Ministry.

"They discussed ways to enhance bilateral exchanges at the political and people-to-people levels," the Embassy

said.

Misri, who was previously India's Ambassador to China, will hold a few meetings with officials on Tuesday, officials said.

His visit followed the meeting between External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar and Chinese Foreign Minister Wang Yi on the sidelines of the meetings related to the Association of Southeast Asian Nations (ASEAN) in Manila on July 21.

PATNA: The Bihar government on Monday announced that it will withdraw all cases lodged against protesters over the NEET paper leak and release those jailed under various charges.

A statement to this effect was issued late in the evening by the state's Home Department, which said that "no adverse legal action – punitive/retaliatory - shall be taken by the government against any individual participating in the protests before 6 pm on 26.07.2026".

According to the police, altogether 694 people had been detained for enforcing the Bihar bandh called on July 25 by pro-Left students' unions and, after letting off 339 minors, the remaining 355 were booked under relevant laws, and were facing trial before the courts concerned.

Those who were arrested by the police in connection with the unrest that began in the state on July 22, when a procession taken out by

activists of AISA managed to reach the vicinity of the chief minister's residence, include CPI(ML) Liberation MLA Sandeep Saurav – who was picked up a day prior to the bandh, and former state minister Tej Pratap Yadav – who was taken into custody on Saturday evening for trying to enforce the shutdown.

The statement made it clear that the "legal process for withdrawal of all FIRs, criminal complaints and show-cause notices" against individuals who took part in the protests "will be initiated immediately".

"Furthermore, all the persons arrested/detained in connection with the cases... shall be released immediately", and "no action, directly or indirectly will be taken against such individuals in future as well", it said.

The announcement came barely a few hours after All India Students' Association (AISA) president Neha Bora, who was

among those spearheading the protests at Jantar Mantar in New Delhi, had called on Bihar DGP Vinay Kumar and submitted a memorandum seeking withdrawal of all the cases and release of those arrested.

She had also told reporters that the state could witness "protests on the scale of Jantar Mantar in Delhi" if the demands were not met, and voiced surprise that the Samrat Choudhary government in Bihar was allegedly acting in a high-handed manner "even as the Union government has assured there will be no coercive action". CPI(ML) Liberation general secretary Dipankar Bhattacharya, to whose party AISA is affiliated, expressed delight over the development.

Bhattacharya, who had taken part in the protests at Jantar Mantar, shared screenshots of the Bihar Home Department statement on X, saying "another retreat for the BJP, victory for the people".

From Page 1

Parl deadlock

According to sources, all political parties have agreed to discuss the Bill to amend the anti-paper leak law on Tuesday.

The Speaker announced in the Lok Sabha that he has allocated six hours for the debate on the Bill and if necessary, more time can be given based on the sense of the House.

The proposed legislation was brought as a response from the government to the students' protests led by the CJP, which started on June 20 and culminated after 36 days on July 25 following resignation of Pradhan and acceptance of other demands by the government.

According to the Bill, investigations into paper leak cases are to be completed within two months. For organised crimes, the Bill proposes a minimum sentence of seven years and a fine of up to Rs 10 crore.

The present law has provisions for a minimum of three to five years of imprisonment to curb cheating and those involved in organised crimes of cheating face five to 10 years of imprisonment and a minimum fine of Rs 1 crore.

All the states and UTs will be empowered to set up fast-track courts, which will conduct hearings swiftly and complete the trial within three months of filing of the chargesheet, according to the Bill.

The Centre will be empowered to set up a special task force to investigate cases of paper leaks in certain circumstances, it says.

After the introduction of the Bill, Speaker Birla said it was the first step towards improving the public examination process.

The 2024 law was brought in when the government faced raging paper leak controversies. Before this legislation, there was no specific substantive law to deal with unfair means adopted or offences committed by various entities involved in the conduct of public examinations by the central government and its agencies.

The Act aimed to prevent unfair means in the public examinations conducted by the Union Public Service Commission (UPSC), the Staff Selection Commission (SSC), the railways, banking recruitment examinations and the National Testing Agency (NTA), among others.

In the wake of student protests, Prime Minister Narendra Modi had promised a law to deal with cases like the NEET-UG paper leak. He also said that cases of accused in such cases will be tried in fast-track courts.

Modi on Sunday also announced the constitution of a high-powered task force headed by Infosys co-founder Nandan Nilekani to recommend reforms to make the exam system leakproof.

The Bill introduced in the Lok Sabha notes that in recent years, there have been some incidents of question paper leaks and malpractices in

examinations conducted by public examination authorities, "which tend to affect the transparency and fairness of the public examination system".

The amendment Bill seeks to empower all the state governments and UT administrations to designate any court of session to be a special fast-track court to try offences under the proposed law.

It also provides that the proceedings in such courts are continued on a day-to-day basis and the trial is completed within three months from the date of filing of the chargesheet.

The Bill also empowers the Central government to constitute a special task force for investigation of any offence, if necessary.

It has provisions for "engagement of services of other government agencies by public examination authority", "preparation of norms, standards and guidelines" and "reporting of incidents of unfair means or offences", among others.

Pre-examination activities such as pre-audit for the examination readiness of the public examination centres, candidate check-in, biometric registration, security and screening, seat allocation, question paper setting and loading, invigilation in the examination, post-examination activities and guidelines for providing scribes were also part of the norms.

The Bill outlines 15 illegal acts including leaking question papers, tampering with OMR sheets, creating fake websites and issuing fake admit cards.

SC

"Discipline is integral to the democratic process."

The court also agreed to hear a separate plea filed by family members of police personnel who were injured during the clashes. Justice Bagchi said the court was equally concerned about injuries suffered by both protesters and police personnel. "Injury to individuals, be it to policemen or students, is of equal concern," he said, adding that the state may have to explain why police personnel were not provided adequate protective equipment such as helmets while managing protests.

The petitions stem from the July 20 march towards Parliament, organised as part of a nationwide student agitation demanding action over alleged examination irregularities and the resignation of Union Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan. Protesters alleged they were stopped through barricading, tear gas, baton charges and large-scale detentions when they attempted to move towards Parliament. At least 60 protesters were reportedly injured during the police action, according to one of the petitions. The demonstrations later spread to several cities before the agitation, led by the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP), was called off on Saturday after Pradhan resigned and the government accepted the group's other demands.

One of the petitions, filed by advocate Shailendra Mani Tripathi through Advocate-on-Record Chand Qureshi, seeks nation-

wide guidelines to regulate police action during public protests. It names the Union government, the Delhi government, the Delhi Police Commissioner and all states and Union Territories as respondents, seeking enforcement of fundamental rights under Articles 14, 19 and 21 of the Constitution.

The plea seeks a ban on deploying plainclothes personnel for crowd-control duties and arrests during protests, arguing that unidentified officers violate safeguards laid down by the Supreme Court in earlier judgments requiring visible identification. It also calls for standard operating procedures governing the use of prohibitory orders under Section 163 of the Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, alleging that repeated restrictions have effectively converted the constitutional right to assemble into a permission-based system. The petition further questions the application of Section 152 of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, contending that its broad wording could discourage peaceful political dissent.

Apart from seeking implementation of police reforms directed in the Prakash Singh judgment, the petition asks for the constitution of an independent judicial commission or a Special Investigation Team headed by a retired Supreme Court judge to investigate the alleged police excesses, arbitrary detentions and allegations of gender-based misconduct during the July 20 protest. It also seeks registration of cases against police personnel allegedly involved in assaults on protesters, including female students.

During Monday's hearing, Solicitor General Tushar Mehta told the court he would assist the bench impartially. Senior advocate Vikas Singh referred to alleged attacks on students in Bihar, while advocate Fauzia Shakil claimed that police there had used AK-47 rifles against protesters.

Separately, the Delhi High Court had earlier sought responses from the Centre and Delhi Police on petitions alleging excessive force during the July 20 march and directed authorities to preserve CCTV footage and other video records related to the police action.

CBI absence

director of prosecution to deputise a public prosecutor to the designated court.

Judge Baliga assumed charge of the special court on Saturday. Earlier, on July 23, the Delhi High Court had notified that her court would function as a Specially Designated Fast Track Court to hear offences under the Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024, along with related cases. The notification followed Prime Minister Narendra Modi's announcement that fast track courts would be set up to ensure speedy trials in paper leak cases.

Before the case was transferred, Special Judge Ajay Gupta on Friday extended the judicial custody of all 13 accused till August 6. The court also rejected the bail plea of paediatrician Dr Manoj Bhagwanrao Shirure, observing that the investigation

prima facie showed he was "one of the active conspirators of an organised paper leak gang".

The National Testing Agency (NTA) cancelled the NEET-UG examination conducted on May 3 after allegations of a paper leak surfaced. A fresh examination was held on June 21.

CJP alleges

if the assurances were not honoured."

The organisation also launched 'Saakshi', a digital platform to preserve evidence from the protest movement and connect affected students with legal assistance. Senior advocate and Rajya Sabha MP Kapil Sibal announced a Rs.1 crore contribution towards the initiative and appealed to lawyers across the country to join the legal aid effort.

Addressing a joint press conference with Rajya Sabha MP and senior advocate Kapil Sibal, CJP spokespersons Ashutosh Ranka and Saurav Das said the organisation was yet to receive the Centre's promised written agreement on the withdrawal of criminal cases and protection from future legal action.

The CJP had suspended its nationwide agitation on July 25 after three rounds of talks with the Centre, following the resignation of former Union Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan over the alleged NEET-UG examination irregularities. The Centre had assured the organisation that no coercive action would be taken against peaceful protesters and had agreed to work towards withdrawing FIRs, compensating families of students who died by suicide in accordance with existing rules, and considering the CJP's five-point charter on examination reforms. BJP leader Pralhad Joshi was subsequently appointed as the new Union Education Minister.

However, Das said the organisation had since received multiple reports of students and other protesters being "targeted, detained or arrested" by state agencies. "Our decision to suspend the nationwide protest was taken in good faith and solely on the basis of the government's assurance. Any departure from that assurance would amount to a breach of public trust with lakhs of young Indians who chose dialogue over protest," he said.

The CJP urged Union Ministers J.P. Nadda and Jitendra Singh to immediately ensure the release of all detained protesters, prevent any retaliatory action and facilitate the withdrawal of FIRs. It also reminded the Centre of its commitment to provide a written guarantee on the issue by Tuesday.

Ranka alleged that hundreds of students had been arrested in Bihar and West Bengal, while volunteers were being detained or surveilled in Delhi and other states. He said the agreement reached with the Centre included withdrawal of all FIRs filed against protesters and organisers across the country and an assurance that no fresh cases would be registered in the future. If the government failed to implement these commitments, he warned, the CJP would have "no option but to sit on protest again."

The warning comes amid continuing police action in Bihar. Patna Senior Superintendent of

Police Kartikeya K. Sharma said 86 people arrested during the July 25 violence near Gandhi Maidan had been sent to judicial custody, while 60 others, including women and minors, were released on personal bonds. Multiple FIRs have also been registered in connection with the July 22 and July 25 protests. In a separate incident, a police personnel in Siwan was suspended after allegedly firing an AK-47 during violence linked to the bandh.

Reaffirming its commitment to the movement, the CJP said its legal team had been working with lawyers across the country since the first day of the agitation to secure the release of detained protesters and provide legal assistance. Das said the organisation had consulted Kapil Sibal throughout the movement, particularly before withdrawing the protest, fearing that participants could later be targeted through legal action. "We have seen this playbook before. We wanted to ensure the youth movement was not weakened by politically motivated cases," he said.

To strengthen legal support, the CJP launched 'Saakshi', a digital platform that allows protesters and witnesses to securely upload original photographs and videos from demonstrations. The platform creates a cryptographic fingerprint for every uploaded file, preserving it as tamper-evident evidence that can be shared with verified legal aid teams. Das appealed to protesters, particularly those who participated in the July 20 'Chalo Sansad' march, to upload any evidence of alleged police brutality or misconduct.

Kapil Sibal announced that he would contribute Rs.1 crore towards the initiative and appealed to lawyers across the country to join the effort. He said the platform would also maintain a nationwide database tracking legal action against protesters, identify those requiring legal assistance and connect them with lawyers willing to represent them. "Wherever the law is misused and false cases are filed against peaceful protesters, we will stand with them," Sibal said.

The CJP reiterated that while it had chosen dialogue over confrontation after the Centre accepted several key demands, it expected every assurance made during negotiations to be implemented in both letter and spirit. Failure to release detained protesters, withdraw FIRs and provide the promised written agreement, it said, would leave the organisation with no choice but to restart its nationwide agitation.

India summons

commercial vessel MV Omorf which resulted in the tragic death of an Indian national," the ministry said in a statement.

It added that the attack threatened the safety of maritime navigation, freedom of movement at sea, and international trade. The ambassador was asked to pass on India's concerns to Ukrainian authorities and told that strikes putting civilian seafarers at risk are unacceptable and should not happen again.

The move comes days after India summoned Russia's charge d'affaires last Tuesday over a separate strike on a merchant vessel off Ukraine's coast that left 10 people

dead, including four Indian crew members.

Responding to Monday's development, the Ukrainian embassy in New Delhi said it offered its deep sympathy to the families of the Indian seafarers who died amid the worsening security situation in the Black Sea. It said Ukraine's Foreign Minister Andrii Sybiha had written a letter of condolence to External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar, and that the two ministers were expected to speak soon on the situation in the region.

The embassy placed responsibility for the danger at sea on Russia, saying that risks to civilian shipping could be reduced if warnings issued by Kyiv were acted on promptly. It said Ukraine had repeatedly alerted its partners, including senior Indian officials, about growing threats in the Black Sea, and had kept them informed of steps taken to stop the movement of military cargo supporting Russia's war effort.

The embassy also noted that India's Directorate General of Maritime Administration had issued an advisory on July 23 for Indian ships and vessels carrying Indian crew passing through the Black Sea.

"The only sustainable way to restore maritime security is to increase international pressure on the Russian Federation to end its attacks on civilian shipping," the embassy said, calling for early and preventive action by authorities to protect seafarers and safeguard maritime security in the region.

Govt says no study

years, with over 20 crore two-wheelers and above 3 crore petrol cars now running on these blends. "There is no verified evidence of widespread engine failure or vehicle breakdown attributable to ethanol blending," he said, adding that carmakers are still honouring warranty claims for vehicles using E20.

On mileage, the government said fuel economy depends on driving conditions, habits and how well a vehicle is maintained. Any drop in mileage for vehicles built for E10 petrol is usually around 3 to 5 per cent, it said, while E20 brings a higher octane rating, better anti-knock properties and smoother engine performance, along with about 30 per cent lower carbon emissions than E10.

The government also cited industry figures, saying one major automaker serviced 2.84 crore vehicles in 2025-26, including 1.5 crore not originally certified for E20, without finding corrosion or wear tied to the fuel. Another company tracked 1.4 crore E20-run vehicles over an extended period with similar results.

Gopi said ethanol supply has been planned to also support future petrol demand growth and higher blends down the line, and that foodgrain use for ethanol is calibrated carefully, with food security and public distribution needs given top priority.

Nitin Gadkari

and alleging that he and his family profited from it. The suit

states that the claims are "false, malicious and grossly defamatory" and seeks permanent injunctions against such content.

The development comes about two weeks after an FIR was registered in Nagpur against four social media influencers, including YouTuber-politician Manish Kashyap, over alleged misinformation related to the E20 programme, which is administered by the Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas.

Gyaneshwari

medallist finished with a total of 199kg, lifting 87kg in snatch and 112kg in clean and jerk. Two unsuccessful attempts in the clean and jerk prevented her from climbing higher on the podium as Nigeria's Rafiatu Folasade Lawal secured gold with a record-breaking performance.

On the athletics track, M Sreeshankar comfortably advanced to the men's long jump final after clearing the automatic qualification mark of 8m with an opening leap of 8.01m. Returning after a career-threatening patellar tendon injury that forced him to miss the Paris Olympics, the 2022 Commonwealth Games silver medallist was the only athlete in Group A to qualify automatically.

"It was tricky conditions for everyone. It was cold, windy and there was rain in between, but I managed to qualify with my first jump. I am very excited for the final," Sreeshankar said after the event.

Compatriot Lokesh Sathyanathan also progressed, with his best effort of 7.77m earning him a place among the top 12 qualifiers across both groups.

India's boxing team also enjoyed a successful outing as former world youth champion Sachin Siwach and Commonwealth Games debutant Ankush reached the quarterfinals, moving one win away from assured medals. Sachin defeated England's William Hewitt 4-1 in the men's 60kg bout despite a point deduction in the final round and will next face Botswana's Treasure Moremi. Ankush dominated Antigua and Barbuda's Jan Zalaan 5-0 in the men's 80kg category to book his place in the last eight.

There was disappointment in the men's 100m, where national record holder Gurindervir Singh failed to advance beyond the heats. The 25-year-old clocked 10.39 seconds to finish second in his heat behind Jamaica's Rohan Watson but ended up 28th overall, falling short of the qualification spots. Gurindervir had entered the Games after setting the national record of 10.09 seconds earlier this year and was aiming to become the first Indian to break the 10-second barrier.

In swimming, two-time Olympian Sajjan Prakash qualified for the men's 200m butterfly final after clocking 1:58.59 to finish second in his heat behind Scotland's Duncan Scott (1:58.29), making the cut as the sixth fastest overall. Aryan Nehra also reached the men's 800m freestyle final, while para swimmer Swatik Patel advanced to the men's 100m backstroke SB9 final, ensuring India remained in contention across multiple disciplines.

OPPOSITION COUNTERS WITH ‘PAPER CHOR’ JIBE

BJP greets Pradhan with ‘Zindabad’ slogans in Parl after resignation

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: BJP leader Dharmendra Pradhan, who resigned as Union education minister following students’ protests over NEET row, was welcomed by some BJP leaders in the Parliament complex on Monday with a traditional cap and stole amid slogans like ‘Pradhan Zindabad’.

As Pradhan walked into Parliament through the Makar Dwar, a group of BJP MPs were waiting for him. They greeted him with chants of ‘Dharmendra Pradhan Zindabad’, draped a scarf around his shoulders and escorted him into the building. Former minister was seen acknowledging the greetings with folded hands.

Opposition MPs at the same time shouted slogans like ‘Chor Chor, Paper Chor’ and hit out at the ruling dispensation for felicitating Pradhan.

Congress leader Pawan



Former Union Education minister Dharmendra Pradhan being greeted during the Monsoon session of Parliament, in New Delhi, Monday

Khera said, “These are the same people who even welcomed the rapists in the Bilkis Bano case, so let’s leave them aside. Pradhan is an RSS hero because he implemented the RSS agenda through the education ministry. That’s why he’s their hero. But as far as Pradhan is concerned, people now know his true self

as we can see on social media and on roads.”

Hitting out at the government, Congress deputy leader in the Lok Sabha Gaurav Gogoi alleged that the BJP government is “not serious” about reforming the education system and termed the proposed anti-paper leak legislation a

Highlights

» These are the same people who even welcomed the rapists in the Bilkis Bano case, so let’s leave them aside, said Khera

» Opposition MPs protested in the Parliament House complex over alleged ‘police brutality’ against student protesters during the agitation on the NEET paper leak issue

“cosmetic Bill”.

“I see that this government is not serious about reforming the Indian education system. Therefore, they have brought a cosmetic Bill... we already know that a main culprit of a previous scam, was let go by the court. Because sufficient evidence was not gathered, so what use of

this fast-track amendment Bill. When this BJP government is hell-bent upon protecting those who are indulging in all this kind of scams,” Gogoi said.

Meanwhile, Opposition MPs, including Congress leaders Rahul Gandhi and Priyanka Gandhi Vadra, protested in the Parliament House complex on Monday over alleged “police brutality” against student protesters during the agitation on the NEET paper leak issue and demanded Home minister Amit Shah’s apology.

As Pradhan crossed them, Opposition members hooted and raised slogans. The charged mood outside quickly spilt into the House. Carrying placards and a large banner, several MPs protested in front of the steps of the Makar Dwar of Parliament. They raised slogans, demanding answers from the home minister over alleged police excesses against protesting students.

Rahul attacks BJP: ‘Govt fears both truth & non-violent protest’

Gandhi slams govt over the tribal protests against the Ken-Betwa river linking project in Madhya Pradesh

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Congress leader Rahul Gandhi on Monday attacked the BJP over the tribal protests against the Ken-Betwa river linking project in Madhya Pradesh, alleging that instead of listening to them, their peaceful agitation is being crushed with police force.

Gandhi also alleged that the Modi government fears both truth and non-violent resistance.

“The tribal brothers and sisters of Madhya Pradesh sat on a water satyagraha and hunger strike because their land was taken away for the Ken-Betwa project, but they received neither fair compensation nor dignified rehabilitation,” the leader of Opposition in Lok Sabha said in a post in Hindi on X.

The truth is that tribals are the original owners of the country—the first right to water, forests, and land belongs to them alone, Gandhi said.



Security personnel interact with people at the banks of the Barana river as the 15-day protest against the Ken-Betwa Link and other development projects ended after police cleared the agitation site, in Chhatarpur

And their “satyagraha” is because that very right is being snatched from them today, he alleged.

In their unique way, their demand is simply this: provide a proper means of livelihood—or else life is no different from a funeral pyre. But even this is unacceptable to the BJP government. Instead of listening to them, their peaceful protest is being crushed with police force,” Gandhi said.

“We stand with our tribal brothers and sisters. We will

secure justice for them—compensation and rehabilitation will have to be provided,” the former Congress chief said.

The Rs 44,605-crore Ken-Betwa Link Project is the country’s first river-linking project under the National Perspective Plan. It aims to irrigate 1.062 million hectares of land, provide drinking water to about 6.2 million people and generate hydropower in the drought-prone Bundelkhand region spanning Madhya Pradesh and Uttar Pradesh.

Bihar cop suspended over purported AK-47 use during student protest

PATNA: A police constable was suspended after a purported video showing him using an AK-47 rifle during a student protest in Bihar’s Siwan district on July 25 went viral on social media, officials said on Monday.

Siwan SP Puran Kumar Jha told news agency, “The constable, posted with the District Intelligence Unit (DIU), has been suspended with immediate effect after a video purportedly showing him using an AK-47 rifle during a student protest went viral on social media. Departmental proceedings have also been initiated against him.”

No one was injured in the firing,” he added.

The SP said an inquiry has been initiated to ascertain the



A security official near a vandalised vehicle during the ‘Bihar Bandh’, in Patna, Saturday

circumstances under which the constable used the AK-47 rifle during the protest.

“There were clear instructions to the police force not to open fire during the demonstration,” he said.

On July 25, members of Left-wing student organisations staged demonstrations and clashed with police in sev-

eral districts in support of the Bihar Bandh called against the NEET paper leak and police action on protesting students.

The bandh turned violent in Patna, Saran, Siwan, Aurangabad, Bhagalpur, Sitamarhi, Purnia and Bhojpur, while Samastipur, Nawada, Nalanda, Madhubani and Sheikhpura witnessed mild protests.

Protesters pelted stones and bricks at police personnel at Dak Bungalow crossing in Patna, following which several students were detained.

Leader of Opposition in the Bihar Assembly Tejashwi Yadav also raised the issue and accused the police of opening fire on students during the Bihar Bandh protest in Siwan.

CHANDIGARH/NEW DELHI: Congress MPs from Punjab protested at Parliament, while other Opposition parties sought the resignation of Education Minister Harjot Singh Bains over the unravelling of a cheating racket in an exam to recruit pharmacy officers.

MPs Amrinder Singh Raja Warring, Amar Singh, Gurjeet Singh Aujla, and Sher Singh Ghubaya protested outside Parliament, seeking accountability from the AAP government.

The Akali Dal demanded an impartial probe into the matter.

On July 19, Punjab Police dismantled a highly sophisticated, inter-state cheating racket that was active during Sunday’s pharmacy officer exam.

Closer Look

» MPs Amrinder Singh Raja Warring, Amar Singh, Gurjeet Singh Aujla, and Sher Singh Ghubaya protested outside Parliament, seeking

accountability from the AAP government
» Police investigation indicated that there was no leak of paper and no involvement of any official authority

The police arrested seven key conspirators and detained 28 candidates in connection with the matter. Twenty-seven battery-operated wireless cheating devices were recovered in the process.

Among the gadgets seized were pen cameras and real-time dictation tools.

Nearly 7,000 candidates appeared for 454 pharmacy officer posts across 25 exam

centres in Faridkot, Kotkapura, and Ferozepur, in an exam conducted by Baba Farid University of Health Sciences on behalf of the state Health and Family Welfare Department.

Police investigation indicated that there was no leak of paper and no involvement of any official authority.

Opposition parties also alleged that papers were leaked in Punjab in Naib Tehsildar

Govt launches Atmanirbhar Panchayat Programme, SAMARTH Portal

NEW DELHI: Union Panchayati Raj Minister Rajiv Ranjan Singh on Monday launched the Atmanirbhar Panchayat Programme, the SAMARTH Panchayat Portal and released the Model Own Source Revenue (OSR) Rules aimed at strengthening the financial autonomy of Panchayati Raj Institutions (PRIs) and enhancing grassroots governance.

Launching the initiatives at a function in Krishi Bhawan here, Singh said financially empowered and technologically enabled panchayats were central to the vision of a developed India by 2047.

“Self-reliant Panchayats are key to realising the vision of Viksit Bharat @2047,” the minister said, adding that strengthening local bodies with digital tools and sustainable revenue streams would improve governance and accelerate inclusive rural development.

According to the ministry, the Atmanirbhar Panchayat Programme will help gram and block panchayats identify local assets and opportunities and develop them into revenue-generating projects with technical support from the Centre. The projects will be financed through public-private partnerships, corporate social responsibility (CSR) funds, convergence with government schemes and bank financing, with NABARD and HUDCO serving as institutional partners.

The ministry plans to develop 350 such projects over four years, including 50 in the first year and 100 annually over the following three years.

The minister also launched the SAMARTH Panchayat Portal, a digital platform designed to enable gram panchayats to manage the entire lifecycle of their own source revenues, including taxpayer registration, demand generation, online payments, collections and real-time monitoring.

Prez to honour Bastar Pandum 2026 winners at Rashtrapati Bhavan

Chhattisgarh CM to lead 209-member delegation

OUR CORRESPONDENT

RAIPUR: Chhattisgarh’s rich tribal culture, folk traditions and cultural heritage are set to receive another significant national recognition.

A 209-member delegation led by Chief Minister Vishnu Deo Sai will pay a courtesy visit to President Droupadi Murmu at Rashtrapati Bhavan in New Delhi on July 30.

The delegation will comprise Deputy Chief Minister Vijay Sharma, Culture minister Rajesh Agrawal, winners of Bastar Pandum 2026, representatives of Bastar’s traditional tribal leadership institutions,



Padma Shri awardees and public representatives.

President Murmu has also hosted a special banquet in honour of the festival’s winning participants, Paragana Manjhis, Manjhis, Chalkis and Padma Shri awardees. The delegation will tour Rashtrapati Bhavan and visit prominent national landmarks in New

Delhi. The occasion marks a significant national recognition of Bastar’s tribal culture, traditional governance institutions and Chhattisgarh’s cultural heritage.

CM Sai said the state government is committed to preserving and promoting the rich heritage of tribal communities while giving it national and international recognition. He described the presence of Bastar’s artists and traditional community leaders at Rashtrapati Bhavan as a matter of pride for the entire state and said the honour reflects the country’s respect for Bastar’s culture, traditions and tribal communities.

STEP TO MAKE EXAM SYSTEM LEAKPROOF

Nandan Nilekani to S Somnath: Meet the experts on Centre’s exam reform task-force

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Prime Minister Narendra Modi has announced the constitution of a high-powered six-member task force headed by Infosys co-founder Nandan Nilekani to recommend reforms to make the exam system leakproof.

Here is a sneak peek at who the six members of the task force are:

Nandan Nilekani

Nilekani, the co-founder and chairman of Infosys, is known as the architect behind India’s Aadhaar digital identity programme – UIDAI. He also played a key role in the development of the Unified Payments Interface (UPI), helping shape India’s digital public infrastructure through interoperable payments.

In 1981, Nilekani joined N R Narayana Murthy and five others to co-found Infosys after leaving his job at Patni Computer Systems.

Significance in task force:

Key Points

» In 1981, Nilekani joined N R Narayana Murthy and five others to co-found Infosys after leaving his job at Patni Computer Systems

» Somnath served as the chairman of the Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO) and as secretary in the Department of Space from 2022 to 2025

Tapen Deka

A 1988-batch IPS officer of Himachal Pradesh cadre, Deka served as the director of the Intelligence Bureau (IB) from June 2022 to June 2026.

A veteran intelligence officer, he played a key role in counter-terrorism operations, including the 26/11 Mumbai attacks, the crackdown on the Indian Mujahideen, and security operations in Jammu and Kashmir and the Northeast.

Significance in task force: To help strengthen the security framework, help in examining digital solutions that can strengthen each stage of the examination process, from question paper security

to candidate verification and result processing.

Anita Karwal

A 1988-batch IAS officer, Karwal has more than 36 years of experience in public administration, with a focus on school education.

She served as the CBSE chairman (2017–2021) and later as secretary, Department of School Education and Literacy, playing a key role in shaping the National Education Policy (NEP) 2020 and the National Curriculum Framework.

She also faced student protests as the CBSE chairman when the board examination question paper was leaked in 2018.

Significance in task force: To provide her education policy expertise.

V Kamakoti

Kamakoti has been the director of IIT Madras since 2022 and is known for leading the research team that developed India’s first indigenous microprocessor, Shakti.

An alumna of IIT Madras, Kamakoti is a member of the National Security Advisory Board and chairs the Artificial Intelligence (AI) task force set up by the Ministry of Commerce and Industry. He also leads several national programmes on indigenous microprocessor development.

Significance in task force: To provide academic and technical inputs.

Amrit Lal Meena

A Bihar-cadre IAS officer of the 1989 batch, Meena has more than 36 years of administrative experience, including 25 years with the Bihar government and 11 years with the Central government.

He previously served as the chief secretary of Bihar and as secretary in the Ministry of Coal, and held the additional charge of special secretary (logistics) in the Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade (DPIIT).

Significance in task force: To serve as a logistical expert.

UP Police raid volunteer’s home amid Jantar Mantar protest, police deny claims

BISWAJEET BANERJEE

LUCKNOW: The Uttar Pradesh Police allegedly raided the residence of Mohammad Junaid, a volunteer associated with the ongoing student protest at Delhi’s Jantar Mantar, triggering fresh allegations of police intimidation from protesters.

The Cockroach Janata Party (CJP), which spearheaded the agitation, claimed that Junaid has been actively providing food and drinking water to protesters since the movement began.

The party alleged that Uttar Pradesh Police personnel conducted a raid at his residence and detained his father, his minor brother and several relatives living in Meerut in an attempt to pressure him to withdraw from the protest.

According to CJP leaders, the action was intended to discourage volunteers supporting the agitation and create fear among those participating in the movement. They accused the police of targeting families of protesters instead of addressing the issues raised by students.

However, the Meerut Police rejected the allegations, stating that no such detentions had taken place.

Police officials denied that Junaid’s family members or relatives had been taken into custody and dismissed the claims made during the press conference.

Nation Briefs

HIMACHAL: BJP APPOINTS STATE CONVENERS, CO-CONVENERS FOR VARIOUS CELLS

SHIMLA: Himachal Pradesh BJP president Rajeev Bindal on Monday announced the appointments of state conveners and co-conveners for various cells, in an effort to strengthen the organisation. In a statement, Bindal said various cells of the party play a vital role in communicating with different sections of society, conveying their concerns to the organisation and the government, and disseminating the BJP’s policies and ideology to the public. He said Lieutenant Commander Abhishek Patial has been appointed as state convener of the Ex-Servicemen Cell. Brigadier R K Sharma, Colonel M S Katoch, Commander Vijay Jamwal, Subedar Kamlesh Kumar, Subedar Bhagat Singh Wahalwal, and Subedar Vijay Bhatt have been appointed co-conveners.

TN CM VIJAY INSPECTS 45 MLD RECYCLED WATER PLANT IN CHENNAI

CHENNAI: Tamil Nadu Chief Minister C Joseph Vijay on Monday inspected the 45 MLD Tertiary Treatment Reverse Osmosis (TTRO) plant at Koyambedu to review the facility’s operations and the city’s wastewater management initiatives. The Koyambedu facility, operated by the Chennai Metropolitan Water Supply and Sewerage Board (CMWSSB), is part of the state government’s efforts to ensure long-term water security and implement a circular water economy in the metropolis, an official release said. The CMWSSB currently manages the city’s sewage network through 438 pumping stations and 22 treatment plants.

DONATION 'EMBEZZLEMENT' ROW

Ram Temple case: SC directs UP to include forensic auditor in SIT

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: The Supreme Court on Monday took note of setting up of a four-member SIT headed by IGP Kiran S to probe alleged embezzlement of donations at the Ram temple in Ayodhya and asked the Uttar Pradesh government to also include a forensic auditor in the probe team.

Observing that “remedial actions will have to be taken”, a bench comprising Chief Justice Surya Kant and Justices Joy-malya Bagchi and V Mohana said steps will be taken to “ensure transparency”.

Solicitor General Tushar Mehta, appearing for the state government, said that a forensic auditor will also be made a part of the SIT. He said: “We have constituted an SIT headed by Inspector General of Police Mr Kiran S. There is one deputy inspector general (DIG), one senior superintendent of police (SSP) and one additional superintendent of police (ASP).”

The SIT, which was set up on July 25, has taken up the ongoing investigation in the case, he said.

Senior advocate Devdatt Kamat, appearing for one of the petitioners, said that people have given Rs 500 and Rs 1000 notes as donations. “Ultimately the money has not reached the Trust. Whatever the Trust got may be shown on a website so that people will know that their money has reached. This is not adversarial (litigation),” he said.

The bench said that the SIT will have access to everything and moreover the case was not being closed at the moment.

“Right now you all note down the issues. Right now, our entire focus is on investi-



FILE PIC

gation. We must have a speedy and qualitative investigation. We are asking them to submit a report to us. The rest we will decide at a later stage,” the bench said.

The bench directed the SIT to submit a status report in two weeks and posted the pleas for further consideration after that.

On July 20, the bench had asked the Uttar Pradesh government to apprise it about the possibility of setting up an SIT to probe the alleged embezzlement of donations.

Meanwhile, the Shri Ram Janmbhoomi Teerth Kshetra Trust has initiated a comprehensive review of its financial systems in the wake of the offering theft case.

At a meeting of the Trust's Finance Committee, members discussed measures to strengthen transparency and tighten safeguards in the handling of donations. Acting General Secretary Krishna Mohan directed that salaries and payments to Trust employees, engineers and contractual staff should be released on time without any delay.

The committee resolved to introduce stronger digital safeguards by maintaining a secure audit trail for every financial transaction. Regular internal reviews of donation receipts, deposits and disbursements will be conducted to detect

Land deal under ‘scanner’

BISWAJEET BANERJEE

AYODHYA: Investigators probing the Ram Temple offering theft case have identified a plot allegedly bought with Rs 24 lakh in cash by prime accused Ramshankar Yadav alias Tinnu, suspected to be stolen donation money, sources said.

Tinnu allegedly purchased the land in his son Ravi Yadav's name in Sahadatganj around a year ago. While records show about Rs 9 lakh was paid through banking channels, investigators suspect another Rs 24 lakh was paid in cash.

The transaction surfaced during Tinnu's custodial interrogation and scrutiny of land records. Police are preparing to attach the property as suspected proceeds of crime.

The land was allegedly bought from a relative of a senior BJP leader. Sellers were questioned to verify the payment details. The registered value is around Rs 35 lakh, while its market value is estimated at nearly Rs 50 lakh.

irregularities at an early stage.

The Trust is also considering strengthening its coordination with the bank by introducing enhanced alert and verification mechanisms.

Success of student stir proves Mahatma Gandhi's methods still work: Wangchuk

Cites Ladakhi tradition to clarify ministers breaking fast signified ‘victory’

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: Climate activist Sonam Wangchuk on Monday said the success of the recently concluded student-led agitation had reaffirmed the relevance of Mahatma Gandhi's methods, asserting that non-violent resistance could still move governments and bring about change.

After paying tributes to Mahatma Gandhi at Rajghat, Wangchuk also clarified that Union ministers Jitendra Singh and JP Nadda helping him end his hunger strike was, according to Ladakhi tradition, a sign that the government had yielded to the protesters' demands and not a political endorsement.

“I wanted to pay my tribute to Babu (Mahatma Gandhi). His path is as relevant today as it was 100 years ago. This experiment is successful today,” he said.



Activist Sonam Wangchuk, with his wife Gitanjali J Angmo, visits Rajghat to pay tributes to Mahatma Gandhi in New Delhi, Monday PTI

Wangchuk said: “In Ladakh, when protests happen, it is believed that if a government representative or some big leader breaks your fast, it is considered a victory. They are bowing to you while feeding you,” he said, adding that if no government representative turns up, a child or an elderly person traditionally breaks the

fast. “In Ladakh, this is considered victory, maybe it is different in Delhi,” he said.

Wangchuk said the latest agitation had once again demonstrated that Gandhi's philosophy of non-violent resistance remained relevant. “People kept saying such tactics would not work on this government. I believe it is more about taking

the message to the people, and every government ultimately listens to the people,” he said.

He congratulated the organisers and participants, saying the movement succeeded because it remained peaceful despite police action. “It did not succeed because of batons and stones, but because of peaceful protest. The baton charge would have made the situation worse,” he said.

On the resignation of former Union education minister Dharmendra Pradhan, Wangchuk said, “The resignation is a start. Reforms would make the country better,” while stressing that proposed legislation should be thoroughly debated in Parliament.

He expressed hope that government assurances would be honoured and no action would be taken against peaceful protesters.

Mizoram seeks enhanced calamity relief from Centre

AIZAWL: The Mizoram government on Monday sought enhanced disaster management support from the Centre, including approval to classify African Swine Fever (ASF) as a notified disaster under the State Disaster Relief Fund (SDRF), citing losses of Rs 114.64 crore suffered by pig farmers in 2025.

Disaster Management and Rehabilitation Minister Lalnilawma raised the demands during a meeting with National Disaster Management Authority (NDMA) officials in New Delhi, according to an official statement.

Mizoram had reported 9,711 pig deaths and culled another 3,620 pigs between March and December 2025 to contain the highly contagious viral disease. The state's proposal for an ASF disaster

tag has already been endorsed by the State Disaster Management Authority and sent to the NDMA. Lalnilawma also sought Rs 21 crore in Central Special Assistance for rehabilitation after landslides in Lawngtlai and Chandmari in Aizawl. He pursued a Rs 95.76-crore proposal under Phase-I of the National Earthquake Risk Mitigation Programme and a Rs 50-crore proposal under the National Landslide Risk Mitigation Programme.

The minister also submitted Mizoram's Post Disaster Needs Assessment report for 2021-25 to the Union Home Ministry. It estimates physical damage at Rs 644.71 crore and economic losses at Rs 645.49 crore, with Rs 873.22 crore needed for recovery, reconstruction and rehabilitation. MPOST

Punjab top performer in school education: CM Bhagwant Mann

LUDHIANA: Punjab Chief Minister Bhagwant Mann on Monday said that his government's focus on strengthening government schools, modernising educational infrastructure and investing in teacher training has transformed the state into the country's top performer in school education.

He added that the success of government school students in competitive examinations such as NEET (National Eligibility cum Entrance Test), JEE (Joint Entrance Examination) and the Punjab State Talent Search Examination (PSTSE) reflects the far-reaching impact of the government's education reforms.

He reaffirmed that education remains the most powerful instrument for eliminating poverty and empowering future



Punjab CM Bhagwant Mann greets a public gathering in Qadian, Gurdaspur PTI

generations.

Addressing a gathering after inaugurating Vardhman block at Government Primary School in Lohara, Mann said: “This new block has been constructed for Rs 5 crore. The entire cost has been borne by the Vardhman Textiles Group, for which I sincerely thank the group's leadership. The new block comprises 18 classrooms

Punjab Police intensify anti-gangster drive

CHANDIGARH: Punjab Police on Monday conducted 476 raids at locations allegedly linked to associates of gangsters across the state as part of its “Gangstran Te Vaar” campaign to make Punjab gangster-free.

On Day 188 of the campaign, launched by DGP Gaurav Yadav on January 20, police arrested 260 people and recovered six weapons, taking total arrests to 53,508. Preventive action was also taken against 225 people, while one proclaimed offender was arrested.

Meanwhile, the police's anti-drug drive “Yudh Nashian Virudh” entered its 513th day, with 66 “drug smugglers” arrested and 2.2 kg heroin, 11 kg poppy husk, 505 intoxicant pills and Rs 5 lakh drug money recovered. Total arrests under the drive reached 74,679. Seven people were also persuaded to undergo de-addiction treatment. MPOST

Will see what task force suggests on online NEET: SC

NEW DELHI: The Supreme Court on Monday said it will see what the Nandan Nilekani-led high-powered task force formed by the government suggests on the online conduct of the NEET examination.

A bench of Justices PS Narasimha and Alok Aradhe said some out-of-the-box suggestions are needed especially when transition is made from the physical mode to the online conduct of the NEET examination.

“We need some additional safeguards with respect to cyber security, database protection,” it said.

The bench was hearing a plea filed by RJD MP Sudhakar Singh following the cancellation of the NEET-UG held on May 3 over alleged paper leak and the announcement of re-NEET.

Solicitor General Tushar Mehta, appearing for the Centre, informed the bench that the Union government has taken a very serious view and a high-level committee has been constituted.

He said an announcement was made by the prime minister himself and the high-level committee is headed by Nandan Nilekani, who is an expert in the field of technology.

Mehta said besides Nilekani, other members of the task force are former chairman of ISRO S Somanath, former director of the Intelligence Bureau, Tapan Deka, director of IIT Madras, V Kamakoti, former education secretary Anita Karwal, and logistics expert Amrit Lal Meena. The bench said it is listing the plea filed by RJD MP Sudhakar Singh on next Monday, August 3.

On June 1, the top court refused to accept for urgent hearing the plea filed by Singh for conduct of the NEET-UG 2026 re-test on June 21 in computer-based test mode.

On May 12, the National Testing Agency (NTA) cancelled the NEET-UG held on May 3 for medical admissions amid allegations of paper leak. MPOST

SC seeks Centre's reply on Sibal's plea on anti-defection law's interpretation

NEW DELHI: The Supreme Court on Monday agreed to hear a plea filed by senior advocate Kapil Sibal seeking reconsideration of the Tenth Schedule of the Constitution's interpretation that allows MLAs and MPs to avoid disqualification under the anti-defection law by claiming a merger with another political party.

A bench of Justices PS Narasimha and Alok Aradhe, which issued a notice to the Centre, observed that there are several issues involved which are required to be taken by Parliament. The plea comes against the backdrop of MPs from AAP, Trinamool Congress and the Shiv Sena (UBT) joining the ruling BJP and other political parties recently by invoking the merger provisions under the

Tenth Schedule.

Sibal, an Independent Rajya Sabha MP, said that this issue has “huge repercussions on our policy” as a minority party can become majority while a majority can become a minority due to the provision.

The bench said that the Tenth Schedule, meant for the lawmakers, was passed by Parliament and it is for them to devise a mechanism.

“These are issues typically to be raised on the floor of the House; if not, then before a political party. The Tenth Schedule was intended to regulate a mechanism. We have been seeing it. There are several other issues involved,” Justice Narasimha said.

Sibal alleged that a complete fraud is being played upon.

Justice Narasimha told him, “Who made it? It's the making of the members of Parliament; it is for the legislators to decide. Anyway, we will issue notice and tag the matter.”

Sibal said there is a similar matter related to defection of MLAs from Goa pending before the court.

The bench then tagged the plea along with the Goa matter. Sibal has filed the plea in his personal capacity and sought interpretation of the law.

On July 22, he had sought an urgent listing of his plea, saying it relates to the issue of whether the composition of Parliament can change in the fashion in which it is happening in this country and the interpretation of the Tenth Schedule Paragraph 4 in that context. AGENCIES

‘Beyond the Boardroom’: How Chintan Shivir 3.0 is reimaging governance in Chhattisgarh

Governance must continuously evolve by embracing innovation, reviewing existing systems: CM

OUR CORRESPONDENT

INSIGHT

» For two days, IIM Raipur became a laboratory of ideas

» CM Sai, ministers, senior civil servants and leading policy experts gathered to reflect on a single question: how can governance become



FILE PIC

smarter, more responsive and better prepared for the future?

icy thinking. At a time when governments are expected to deliver faster, more transparent and citizen-centric services, the value of such an exercise lies not in immediate announcements but in creating the space to question established practices, learn from experts and develop a shared vision for the future. Sai argued governance must continuously evolve by embracing innovation, reviewing existing systems and preparing for emerging challenges. The goal is not merely to introduce new initiatives but to strengthen the institutions responsible for delivering them.

Organised by the Department of Good Governance and Convergence in collaboration with IIM Raipur, the retreat brought together policymakers, administrators, academicians and domain experts in an environment that encourages dialogue rather than routine decision-making. Chintan Shivir model has helped in translating ideas into action as its recommendations emerging from previous editions contributed to the implementation of the e-Office system, making file movement in the Secretariat faster and more transparent. The CM Helpline

1076 strengthened grievance redressal, while Sewa Setu integrated more than 520 online public services across 36 departments, making government services more accessible.

Artificial intelligence, digital public infrastructure, blockchain, drones, geospatial technologies and 5G are transforming governance across the world. The discussions focused on how these technologies can become practical instruments for improving governance in Chhattisgarh. NITI Aayog member Prof. Abhay Karandikar highlighted the potential of technology to make governance faster, more transparent and data-driven. The conversations reflected a broader understanding that digital governance is no longer about computerising existing processes. It is about redesigning public administration around efficiency, accessibility and accountability.

Agriculture, the backbone of Chhattisgarh's economy, also featured prominently in the deliberations. Agricultural economist Dr Ramesh Chand

and agriculture expert T. Vijay Kumar stressed the importance of natural farming, climate resilience, crop diversification, value addition and stronger market linkages. The emphasis was not merely on increasing production but on improving farmers' incomes and building sustainable rural livelihoods.

Senior IAS officer and tourism policy expert Suman Billa highlighted Chhattisgarh's unique strengths, its forests, waterfalls, tribal traditions and cultural heritage and argued for a model of sustainable, community-based tourism that creates employment while preserving ecological and cultural assets.

A recurring theme throughout the retreat was the importance of convergence.

Agriculture intersects with technology, tourism depends on infrastructure, and rural development is closely linked with education, entrepreneurship and digital connectivity.

Sai indicated that the recommendations will be translated into concrete policy initiatives in the months ahead.

UP: Teacher brands hot knife on 5-yr-old's private parts, booked

‘Punished’ for urinating in pants

VARANASI: A nursery teacher at a private school in Varanasi allegedly branded a five-year-old boy on his private parts with a heated knife after he urinated in his pants when he was denied permission to use the restroom, police said on Monday.

An FIR was registered against the teacher, the principal and the management of the school after the child's father, Kesari Jaiswal, a lawyer, filed a complaint at the Lalpur-Pandeypur police station.

Jaiswal alleged that his son, a nursery student at Sareen Soni Play School in Pandeypur, returned home on July 24 complaining of pain in his private parts.

On examination, the child's mother found a blister, he said. The father alleged that teacher, Preeti Kushwaha, had inflicted the injury after he urinated in his trousers when he was allegedly denied permission to use the washroom.

According to the complaint, the teacher allegedly took the child to another room, heated a

debris and restore traffic at the earliest.

“Commuters are advised to avoid travelling on the highway until it is declared safe and reopened for traffic, as there is a risk of further landslides and shooting stones. People are also urged not to pay heed to rumours and to rely only on updates issued through the Traffic Police's official social media handles for the latest road status,” the spokesman said.

However, officials said a fresh batch of 3,823 Amarnath pilgrims, travelling in a 140-vehicle convoy to the Balthal base camp under tight security, was allowed to cross the affected stretch after authorities restored one-way traffic on the highway. MPOST

knife on a gas stove and used it to burn his private parts.

Jaiswal said he approached the school principal and management with his wife and son on July 25 to lodge a complaint, but he alleged that no action was taken, following which he approached the police.

Police said an FIR has been registered against Kushwaha, the school management and the principal under relevant provisions of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, including Sections 115(2) (Voluntarily causing hurt), 118(1) (Voluntarily causing hurt or grievous hurt by dangerous weapons or means) and 351(2) (criminal intimidation).

Reacting to the incident, Samajwadi Party president Akhilesh Yadav termed it “extremely serious” in a post on X, saying “its painful and horrifying impact could remain with the child for life”. He said teachers should treat children with compassion and humanity and demanded immediate appropriate action. AGENCIES



EDITORIAL
BEYOND
THE BUZZ

India's decision to prohibit beverage manufacturers from marketing high-caffeine products as "energy drinks", at first glance, may appear semantic. The Food Safety and Standards Authority of India (FSSAI) has argued that no formal Indian standard currently exists for products marketed as "energy drinks". In the absence of such a standard, allowing manufacturers to use the term creates the impression that these beverages belong to a recognised category with proven physiological benefits. Claims such as "vitalises body and mind" or "helps in general weakness" further blur the line between marketing and medical suggestion. Consumers may interpret these statements as endorsements of improved health, endurance or mental performance, even though the primary active ingredient in most of these beverages is caffeine, often combined with sugar and flavouring agents. The regulator's concern is therefore less about vocabulary than about preventing potentially misleading representations.

This issue has become more urgent because India's energy beverage market has grown rapidly. Once considered an urban lifestyle product, high-caffeine beverages have become common in schools, colleges, coaching centres, offices and even small towns. Aggressive pricing, colourful branding and celebrity endorsements have expanded their appeal well beyond athletes or working professionals. Students consume them while preparing for examinations, delivery workers rely on them during long shifts, and young consumers increasingly view them as everyday refreshments rather than occasional stimulants. Such normalisation is precisely why accurate labelling becomes a public health issue. When repeated marketing presents a caffeinated drink as a source of "energy", consumers may overlook the fact that the temporary alertness comes primarily from stimulant effects rather than nutritional value.

Scientific evidence has long cautioned against excessive caffeine intake, particularly among adolescents, pregnant women and individuals with cardiovascular conditions. High caffeine consumption may contribute to disturbed sleep, anxiety, elevated heart rate and dependence in susceptible individuals. The risks increase when multiple cans are consumed within a short period or when such beverages are mixed with alcohol. Equally concerning is the amount of sugar contained in many formulations, adding another dimension to India's growing burden of obesity, diabetes and metabolic disorders. While moderate caffeine consumption is generally considered safe for healthy adults, the lack of clear public understanding of safe limits often leads to overconsumption, especially among younger users. The beverage industry has understandably expressed reservations. Companies argue that abrupt regulatory decisions without prior consultation create uncertainty, disrupt business planning and damage brand reputation. Their demand for greater engagement with regulators is not unreasonable. Effective regulation is often strengthened when policymakers consult industry, scientists, consumer groups and public health experts before introducing significant changes. Transparent dialogue can reduce compliance costs while ensuring that regulations remain practical and scientifically robust. However, consultation cannot become a substitute for regulation. Public health authorities must ultimately act in the interest of consumers, even when commercial interests are affected.

At the same time, regulation must avoid becoming symbolic. Simply removing the words "energy drink" from labels will not automatically make consumers healthier or better informed. If the same products continue to be advertised through influencers, digital platforms and sports sponsorships using imagery that promises stamina, productivity or enhanced performance, the regulatory objective will be diluted. Meaningful reform requires a broader framework. India should establish evidence-based standards governing caffeine limits, mandatory disclosure of caffeine content in large, easily readable fonts, advisory statements for vulnerable groups, restrictions on marketing aimed at children, and clearer nutrition labelling. Consumer education campaigns explaining what caffeine does—and what it does not do—are equally essential. The present debate also reflects a larger shift in food regulation worldwide. Increasingly, governments are recognising that labels are not merely informational; they shape purchasing decisions. Countries across the world have tightened rules governing health claims on foods high in sugar, salt or saturated fat. India has already introduced front-of-pack labelling discussions, strengthened action against misleading advertisements and expanded scrutiny of nutraceuticals and health supplements. The latest directive fits within this broader movement towards ensuring that marketing language does not outpace scientific evidence. Businesses that genuinely innovate have little to fear from such transparency. If a product's benefits are demonstrable, they should withstand objective regulatory scrutiny.

India's booming beverage market will continue to innovate, and consumers will continue seeking products that promise convenience and alertness in increasingly demanding lifestyles. But marketing should never blur the distinction between stimulation and nutrition. Energy cannot simply be claimed because caffeine temporarily reduces fatigue. It must be understood in the broader context of balanced diets, adequate sleep, physical activity and overall health. By insisting that labels reflect regulatory reality rather than advertising aspiration, FSSAI has taken a necessary step. The next challenge is to ensure that this intervention evolves into a comprehensive, science-based policy that empowers consumers with accurate information while encouraging responsible innovation. Public trust in food labels is built not by persuasive slogans but by honesty, evidence and accountability.

ILLNESS TO
WELLNESS



ANIL RAJPUT

THE WRITER IS THE
CHAIRPERSON,
ADVISORY
COUNCIL, ILLNESS
TO WELLNESS
FOUNDATION

The greatest
danger of
hepatitis is its
silence, allowing
preventable
liver damage
to progress
unnoticed for
years before
diagnosis

Breaking the Silence on Hepatitis

World Hepatitis Day 2026 highlights the urgent need to remove barriers to testing, vaccination and treatment, ensuring liver disease is detected early rather than after irreversible damage

What if one of the greatest threats to our health is not something we can see, but something quietly developing within us? For millions of people, liver damage can begin and advance without an obvious warning. A person may feel healthy while a viral infection gradually increases the risk of cirrhosis, liver failure or liver cancer. This silence is what makes hepatitis especially dangerous. It delays testing, weakens urgency and allows a preventable or treatable condition to remain hidden until the consequences become far more serious.

Observed every year on 28 July, World Hepatitis Day reminds us that this silence can no longer be accepted. The 2026 theme, "Hepatitis: Let's Break It Down," calls upon countries and communities to remove the financial, social and systemic barriers that separate people from prevention, diagnosis and treatment. The message is both urgent and hopeful. Hepatitis elimination is possible, but only when information is easy to understand, testing is easy to access and treatment is easy to continue.

The scale of the challenge remains immense. Hepatitis B and C continue to cause large numbers of deaths through cirrhosis and liver cancer. Yet many of these deaths are preventable. Hepatitis B can be prevented through vaccination and controlled through treatment, while hepatitis C can now be cured in most people with oral medicines. Hepatitis A and E, commonly linked with contaminated food and water, remind us that sanitation, hygiene and safe drinking water are also essential parts of liver health.

India's response must therefore operate on several fronts at once. Testing and treatment cannot remain concentrated in a few large hospitals. They must move closer to people through district hospitals, primary health centres, blood banks, antenatal clinics, diagnostic centres and community outreach. Indian research on decentralised and same-day hepatitis C care has shown how simplified testing and faster treatment initiation can reduce the number of patients lost between diagnosis and care.

Rapid diagnostic tools and point-of-care testing can further shorten this journey. A person who screens positive should not have to make repeated journeys, lose wages or wait for weeks before receiving



Millions live with hepatitis without knowing it until severe liver damage develops

confirmatory testing and medical guidance. India's growing experience with affordable generic direct-acting antiviral medicines also shows that innovation is meaningful only when it lowers cost and expands access. The next step is to ensure reliable supplies, trained healthcare workers, patient counselling and follow-up across every district.

Prevention must begin even earlier. Hepatitis B can pass from mother to child during birth, making antenatal screening, timely medical intervention and the hepatitis B birth-dose vaccine critical. Maternal and child health services can integrate hepatitis B prevention into routine pregnancy care so that mothers receive timely guidance and newborns receive protection at the earliest possible stage.

India must also focus on communities that face a higher risk or greater difficulty accessing care, including patients undergoing dialysis, people requiring repeated blood transfusions, people in prisons and those who inject drugs. Reaching these groups is not only a matter of disease control. It is a test of whether our healthcare system can offer confidential, respectful and stigma-free care to everyone.

Breaking the silence around hepatitis will require awareness on a much larger and more sustained scale. Information cannot remain confined to medical institutions or a single commemorative day. Well-planned mass-media campaigns are essential to take clear, accurate and repeated messages to the wider public. Their purpose must be to make hepatitis

easier to understand and early action easier to consider. People need to know that the infection can remain without symptoms, that testing is simple, that hepatitis B can be prevented through vaccination and that hepatitis C can be cured. When these facts become part of public understanding, silence is less likely to be mistaken for safety.

Awareness efforts must also be supported by trusted voices that can reduce fear, correct misinformation and encourage timely action. Doctors, community organisations, educators, public figures and people who have successfully completed treatment can all help make the message more credible and relatable. The objective should not be to create alarm, but to build confidence: confidence to ask questions, seek medical advice, consider testing and act before serious damage occurs. Awareness becomes meaningful only when information leads to informed decisions and timely care.

International experience shows what determined action can achieve. Egypt transformed one of the world's heaviest hepatitis C burdens through a nationwide campaign that tested more than 60 million people and connected those diagnosed to treatment, achieving cure rates above 98 per cent. Georgia combined large-scale screening with referral and treatment systems, screening more than 2.8 million people and treating over 80,000. The Maldives, despite its dispersed island geography, became the first country validated by the World Health Organisation for elimi-

nating mother-to-child transmission of HIV, syphilis and hepatitis B together.

India cannot simply copy the model of another country, but it can adapt the principles behind their success: sustained institutional commitment, widespread public awareness, affordable medicines, local delivery, dependable data and a clear pathway from testing to treatment. Our scale is a challenge, but it can also become our greatest strength when credible information and accessible services reach people consistently across communities.

For individuals and families, awareness must become practical action. People should seek medical advice on hepatitis testing when they may have been exposed, ensure that recommended vaccinations are completed, insist on sterile medical, tattooing and piercing equipment, avoid sharing needles or razors, and support safe blood donation and transfusion practices. Clean water, safe food and good sanitation remain indispensable. We must also resist unscientific "liver detox" claims that can delay proper diagnosis or cause harm.

At the Illness to Wellness Foundation, we believe that wellness begins before symptoms appear. It begins when people receive reliable information, understand their risks and feel confident enough to seek timely care. Awareness campaigns must therefore do more than describe the disease. They must make an often-invisible threat easier to recognise, translate medical knowledge into practical understanding and ensure that the absence of symptoms is never confused with the absence of risk. India possesses the scientific knowledge, pharmaceutical capacity and healthcare foundations required to accelerate hepatitis elimination. What is needed now is the determination to take that knowledge beyond medical institutions and place it in the hands of every individual and family.

This World Hepatitis Day, let us break down silence with awareness, stigma with compassion, delay with early diagnosis and distance with accessible care. A hepatitis-free future must not remain an aspiration for another generation. It must become a shared public health commitment that we begin fulfilling today, because a silent disease should never be allowed a silent victory.

Views expressed are personal

TALKING
SHOP



RAJEEV NARAYAN

THE WRITER
IS A VETERAN
JOURNALIST AND
COMMUNICATIONS
SPECIALIST

Behind India's
\$90-billion
data centre rush
lies a quieter
shortfall—that of
water disclosure,
grid planning
and institutional
foresight. And
this is what
could determine
whether the
celebrated
digital boom
holds or buckles

A Looming Stalemate

As data centres proliferate across India, an unglamorous arithmetic with water, power and infrastructure limits will decide whether the AI dreams sink or swim

"AI is not just virtual. It has physics and real impacts. It has infrastructure, energy and hardware that is unseen. There is always someone suffering."

— Kaveh Madani

Every time an Indian uses UPI, streams a movie or asks an AI a question, somewhere a server wakes up. Electricity flows. Cooling systems engage. Water begins to evaporate. India's digital revolution, celebrated as one of its greatest economic success stories, is also becoming a story of power stations, aquifers and the physical resources that keep the virtual world alive.

Somewhere outside Bengaluru, a groundwater table that has sustained farms for generations is being drawn down faster than it can replenish. A stone's throw away, inside gleaming data centres ringed by chillers and backup generators, thousands of server racks process transactions, store photographs and train AI models for users who will never know what it takes to keep the Cloud afloat. That is the soft, unseen underside of India's data centre boom.

The Boom Itself
The numbers are extraordinary. India's installed data centre capacity has expanded four-fold in five years, from 375 MW in 2020 to 1.5 GW, and is projected to exceed 6.5 GW by Year 2030. \$90 billion in investments are in the pipeline and the Government believes AI-linked infrastructure could attract funding worth \$200 billion. India has emerged as an attractive global destination for data centres. Mumbai, Hyderabad, Delhi-NCR, Bengaluru and Chennai host nearly two-thirds of the country's installed capacity. This is remarkable.

But every server rack that lights up also draws something down. Water from an aquifer. Power from a stretched grid. Land from scarce urban and peri-urban corridors. Behind every celebratory investment announcement lies a grim ques-



Digital infrastructure may be invisible, but its environmental footprint is not

tion: Can the natural infrastructure keep pace with its digital ambitions?

Thirst Beneath
At their heart, data centres are heat machines. Keeping crores of processors from overheating requires enormous quantities of cooling, which primarily still means evaporating water. The scale is sobering. A single 1-MW facility using evaporative cooling can consume up to 2.55 crore litres of water annually. A mid-sized 20-MW campus needs 40 crore litres every year. India's data centres are estimated to have consumed 15,000 crore litres of water in 2025, a figure likely to more than double by 2030 as AI primes demand.

Yet, transparency has not kept pace with growth. A leading operator managing 14 AI-ready data centres admitted to withdrawing 60 lakh kilolitres of water during 2023-24. Such disclosures remain the exception, not the rule. Most still publish broad sustainability commitments instead of real water consumption, making 'water-positive' or 'water-neutral' claims difficult to assess and verify. That is worrisome, because India's digital boom is unfolding in regions already facing severe water stress. Groundwater across urban and peri-urban centres is being extracted faster than it can recharge. Bengaluru has already experienced warnings over water security. A below-normal monsoon, forecast for 2026, will sharpen those concerns.

To be fair, data centres are not India's biggest consumers of freshwater. Coal-fired power plants use over ten times as much, while agriculture dwarfs them both. But that is not the point. An expanding and localized demand is being layered onto an already-stressed system. Much of the demand lies where farmers depend on the same aquifers, often with little visibility into how much water is actually being drawn.

Digital infrastructure may be invisible, but its environmental footprint is not.

Power Problem
Water is only half the story. Electricity may be the larger challenge. The data centre power demand is set to rise from about 1 GW today to 13.5 GW by 2031-32. By 2030, data centres could need as much electricity as an entire mid-sized state. By itself, that is not alarming. India has expanded renewable and conventional generation at record pace, and the grid has accommodated large industrial consumers before.

But data centres are unlike most industries. Steel plants or cement and textile mills can tolerate occasional fluctuations. Data centres cannot. They require uninterrupted quality power every second of every day. That means massive investments in renewable energy backed by storage or dependence on coal-fired baseload generation, an uncomfortable trade-off for a country pursuing ambitious climate goals.

There is another glitch. Hyperscale data centres can go online faster than the generation and transmission infrastructure needed to support them. The result is a mismatch: digital infrastructure can arrive in months while power plants take years. That gap deserves greater policy attention than it receives.

Learning from Others

India is not the first to confront this dilemma. Ireland offers perhaps the clearest warning. After courting global Cloud companies for years, Ireland saw data centres consume one-fifth of the country's electricity by 2023. The pressure on the grid became so acute that restrictions were imposed on new facilities around Dublin until network capacity could catch up. The lesson is not that Ireland built too many data centres. It is that it built them faster than the supporting infrastructure. The US has faced similar pressures.

India has the advantage of learning from them. Some states appear to be moving in that direction and operators are experimenting with liquid and closed-loop cooling tech that reduces water usage, even if they require higher upfront investment or greater electricity use. That is the kind of trade-off policymakers should encourage; solving tomorrow's problems before they become today's crises.

Planning the Invisible

None of this is an argument against data centres. They are a rational response to a digitising economy that processes more than 10,000 crore UPI transactions a year, stores billions of photographs and documents, and is racing to build the computing capacity that AI demands. The question is not whether India should build more data centres; it is whether it can build the water and power systems required.

Water and electricity cannot remain afterthoughts. They must become design elements from the moment projects are conceived, every bit as important

as land or finance. That means requiring large facilities to disclose their water and energy use through standardised metrics, not sustainability claims. It means encouraging new campuses to locate beyond water-stressed urban clusters, while rewarding investment in technologies that reduce freshwater dependence. It means ensuring that long-term power contracts combine renewable generation with storage, so that the AI economy does not raise dependence on coal.

Above all, it means strengthening planning so that transmission lines, substations, water infrastructure and urban services arrive alongside digital infrastructure – not years later. The Cloud may feel weightless. It is anything but. Every search query, digital payment, streamed film and AI prompt passes through buildings filled with steel, concrete, transformers, fibre-optic cables, cooling systems and massive water reserves. The digital economy does not suspend the laws of physics; it simply hides them from view.

A Digital Tomorrow

India has every reason to be optimistic about its digital future. Few countries have built digital public infrastructure as quickly or at comparable scale. But optimism is not a substitute for planning. The countries that lead the next phase of the AI economy will not simply be those that build the most computing capacity. They will be those that build the physical infrastructure capable of sustaining it.

India's data centre boom is about more than servers. It is a test of whether it can match digital ambition with resource realism. Because in the end, the future of the cloud will depend not only on code, but on something far more tangible. Water. Power. And the foresight to build both before they are needed.

The writer can be reached on narayanrajeve2006@gmail.com. Views expressed are personal

AS DRONE ATTACKS RATTLE REGION

Mediators see progress in efforts to halt Iran war

CAIRO: Mediators have achieved progress in getting the United States and Iran back to negotiations, regional officials said Monday, after both sides paused attacks following a period of rapidly escalating tensions. But scattered attacks by armed groups across the region underscored the lingering tensions.

Saudi Arabia said it had shot down drones fired by Iran-backed militias in Iraq that had targeted its petroleum facilities. Iran-backed Houthi rebels in Yemen meanwhile claimed to have attacked Saudi oil facilities as part of a separate but related conflict. It was unclear if they referred to the same attack.

Two drone attacks were reported against a Kurdish Iranian dissident group in Iraq, and Jordan said it had shot down two drones, without saying where they originated. There were no reports of casualties or damage.

Neither the US nor Iran reported carrying out any



Representational Image

attacks for three days — a respite after about two weeks of sustained bombardments that had led to increasing fears of a return to all-out war.

The two regional officials, who spoke on condition of anonymity to discuss the closed-door talks, said mediators led by Qatar and Pakistan were working to bridge the gap between Washington and Tehran to return to an interim ceasefire deal that had

collapsed after the exchanges of fire.

The US has paused attacks after targeting Iranian coastal areas and infrastructure in a nearly two-week escalation sparked by Iran's firing at ships trying to transit the Strait of Hormuz, a crucial waterway for global oil shipments.

US President Donald Trump is "giving talks some space. He's giving it a little bit of room," Mike Waltz, the

Highlights

» Saudi Arabia said it had shot down drones fired by Iran-backed militias in Iraq

» Iran halted its attacks following the US pause

» Experts have questioned how long both the US and Iran can afford to keep up attacks

US ambassador to the United Nations, told Fox News.

Waltz dismissed the idea that the US stockpile of interceptors crucial in defending against Iranian attacks is running low, but experts have questioned how long both the US and Iran can afford to keep up attacks. Iran halted its attacks following the American pause, Tehran's army spokesman told Iranian state TV on Sunday.

Pak intensifies anti-insurgency operation in Balochistan

At least 140 terrorists killed in Mastung

KARACHI: A remote area in the northwest of Pakistan's Balochistan province has become ground zero for an operation by the country's security forces against outlawed insurgent outfits and the banned TTP, with three more terrorists being killed on Monday.

According to figures released by the Inter-Services Public Relations and confirmed by security sources and announcements by the state-run media, cumulatively around 140 terrorists have been killed in different operations so far since July 6 in the Mastung district.

State-run Radio Pakistan said on Monday that security forces had killed three more terrorists.

The terrorists, belonging to

In retaliation, insurgent groups are also carrying out terror activities and continuing guerrilla warfare tactics in the area

insurgent groups and the Tehreek-e-Taliban Pakistan (TTP), were killed under Operation "Shaban" launched by the Pakistan Army, Frontier Corps and police.

According to security sources, the decision to expand and expedite the operation came after the insurgents attacked a police compound checkpoint in Ziarat district on July 6, killing nine police-

Trump says US, Tehran having 'good talks'

WASHINGTON: US President Donald Trump told reporters on Monday that the United States is having "good talks" with Iran "right now."

Trump, on Air Force One on his way to Michigan, said he has "plenty of time" to deal with Iran.

"There's a good chance that something could happen," Trump said about a potential deal with Iran.

The president also said he will ask Russia about providing satellite imagery to assist Iran.

"I'll ask Putin about it," Trump said. "We'll find out."

Separately, Iran's Houthi allies in Yemen said they had targeted the 1,200-km (745-mile) East-West Pipeline carrying oil to Saudi Arabia's main Red Sea port of Yanbu, in retaliation for what they said were Saudi drone incursions into Yemeni airspace.

Iran has said it is not seeking to resume peace talks with the U.S., although it would pause its own attacks for as long as Trump's self-imposed ceasefire continues.

Tehran also said it was still in control of the contested Strait of Hormuz.

Zelenskyy visits Britain as new PM signals more support for Kyiv



The UK will give Ukraine the intellectual property behind its new "Stone Cloak" electronic warfare system

“RUSSIA SHOULD BE IN NO DOUBT OF OUR RESOLVE, AND WE WILL NOT BACK DOWN UNTIL WE ACHIEVE PEACE FOR UKRAINE”

LONDON: Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelenskyy arrived Monday in England for a meeting with Prime Minister Andy Burnham, a visit the British leader said is intended to signal the country's "unwavering" support for Kyiv.

Zelenskyy's visit is the first by a foreign leader since Burnham took office a week ago. His predecessor, Keir Starmer, was in Kyiv less than two weeks ago in his last overseas trip before leaving office.

Burnham will be the fifth British prime minister to deal with Zelenskyy since Russia's full-scale invasion of Ukraine in 2022.

"Russia should be in no doubt of our resolve, and we will not back down until we achieve long lasting and just peace for Ukraine," said Burnham, who has spent the past nine years as mayor of Greater Manchester and has little foreign policy experience.

The trip to a naval base in Portsmouth on England's south coast comes a day before Zelenskyy is expected to meet with US President Donald Trump in Washington.

Zelenskyy posted on X that he had arrived in Britain for the

meeting with Burnham "as well as with our warriors" in the UK

He and Burnham will meet more than 200 Ukrainian military personnel who have spent three weeks in Britain for an exercise aimed at strengthening their fighting capabilities and

measures to counter mines in the Black Sea, the UK government said.

The UK will give Ukraine the intellectual property behind its new "Stone Cloak" electronic warfare system, which is capable of jamming Russian air defenses to stop drones from being detected, Burnham's office said.

Ukraine has expanded its campaign of frequent drone attacks deep inside Russia that have targeted oil facilities, military factories and, most recently, logistical centers, bringing the war home to millions of Russians and raising pressure on President Vladimir Putin.

Astronaut Anil Menon set to undertake maiden spacewalk next week

WASHINGTON: Astronaut Anil Menon is set to undertake his first spacewalk next week as he steps out of the International Space Station to upgrade solar arrays, replace a communications antenna and fix new data and power cables to support operations of the orbital lab.

Menon, who traces his origins to Palakkad in Kerala, is scheduled to undertake three spacewalks beginning August 6 along with fellow astronaut Jessica Meir and prepare the orbital lab for the future installation of the International Space Station Roll-Out Solar Array (IROSA) later this year, NASA said in a statement on Monday.

The IROSA will provide additional power to support critical station operations, including its safe and controlled deorbit.

The spacewalks are scheduled to be held on August 6, August 13 and August 25.

During the second spacewalk on August 13, two astronauts will replace a Space-to-Ground antenna on the orbital complex. The antenna is a critical communication system NASA uses to transmit data and high-speed communication between the Mission Control Centre in Houston and the space station.

During the spacewalk on August 25, the crew members will connect power channel cables and data relay systems as part of ongoing maintenance. The astronauts will also replace a navigational aid used for spacecraft docking on the Harmony module's forward port, NASA said.

Suspect in Berlin Pride attack shot dead by police

BERLIN: German police said a 21-year-old man with a record of Islamist extremist activity was shot dead on Sunday, a day after he allegedly drove a minivan into people near Berlin's Pride celebrations, killing one person. The ramming attack happened in the Tiergarten park near the Brandenburg Gate at about 10 p.m. (2000 GMT) on Saturday.

Authorities said that in addition to the one fatality, 29 people were injured, some by a bladed weapon the attacker wielded.

"Around 6 p.m. (1600 GMT), the suspect involved in yesterday's attack in Tiergarten was located at an allotment garden complex in Spandau," Berlin police wrote on X.

Monster fire stopped growing: France

LEGE-CAP FERRET: France's interior minister said Monday that a monster wildfire has stopped growing after forcing 220,000 people out of their homes in the country's southwest but cautioned that it isn't yet beaten. "It hasn't progressed during the night," the minister, Laurent Nunez, said. "We have

to remain very concentrated, very determined, to go at any moment."

He spoke after French President Emmanuel Macron held a crisis meeting Monday focusing on the massive firefighting effort in the Gironde region and on wildfires elsewhere.

The Gironde blaze has

burned an area four times the size of Paris. The region's prefecture said the situation overnight had remained "globally stable" — a change from previous days where the giant blaze raging since last week edged closer to the wine region city of Bordeaux.

In the adjacent south-

western Landes region, where hundreds of firefighters have been making progress against another virulent but smaller fire, the prefecture said some rain fell overnight and described the conditions as "favourable" for firefighting but also cautioned that they could change.

UNESCO MEETING HELD IN BUSAN

UNESCO adds Brazil's Amazonia theaters to the World Heritage List

SAO PAULO: The UN cultural agency UNESCO on Monday added two theaters in the Brazilian Amazon to its World Heritage List.

The Amazonia Theaters comprise Teatro da Paz in Belem, Para state, and Teatro Amazonas in Manaus, Amazonas state. Both were built in the late 19th century at the height of the rubber boom, and combine European architectural influences with local materials and symbols.

UNESCO said the theaters were designed as "symbols of political and urban ambition." Teatro da Paz, inaugurated in 1878, underscored Belem's role as a key port city, while Teatro Amazonas, inaugurated in 1896, reflected



The Amazonia Theaters comprise Teatro da Paz in Belem, Para state, and Teatro Amazonas in Manaus

the rapid urban development of Manaus during the rubber boom.

Brazil said it nominated the two theaters jointly

because they represented the same historical period and embodied a shared project to modernize and integrate the Amazon region into global commercial and cultural circuits.

"Architecturally and artistically, they blended imported influences and materials with local woods and forest-inspired motifs, creating a distinctive aesthetic that was at once cosmopolitan and deeply Amazonian," the government said in a statement.

Each year, the UNESCO World Heritage Committee designates places considered to be "of outstanding value to humanity."

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Union Bank of India

भारत सरकार का चक्रम

A Government of India Undertaking

LAXMI NAGAR BRANCH

Plot No.-7, Flat No.-G3,G4,G5, G6 & G6A, Ground Floor, Roots Tower, District Centre, Laxmi Nagar, Delhi-110092

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ANNEXURE-I

[Rule - 8(1) POSSESSION NOTICE (For Immovable Property)]

Whereas The undersigned being the authorised officer of Union Bank of India, Laxmi Nagar Branch, Plot No.7, Flat No. G3, G4, G5, G6, G6A, Ground Floor, Roots Tower, Delhi-110092, under the Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement Security Interest (Second) Act, 2002 (Act No. 54 of 2002) and in exercise of powers conferred under Section 13(12) read with rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002 issued a demand notice dated 06.04.2026 calling upon the borrower 1.M/S D K Enterprises (Borrower) At: IX/5326, Old Seelampur Gandhi Nagar, Delhi, Pin: 110031 Mr. 9999947858, 9582353337 2.Mr. Devanand S/o Mr. Sher Singh (Guarantor) At: IX/5326, Old Seelampur Gandhi Nagar, Delhi, Pin: 110031 Mr. 9999947858, 9582353337 to repay the amount mentioned in the notice being Rs.48,83,382.20 (Rupees Forty Eight Lacs Eighty Three Thousand Three Hundred Eighty Two and Twenty Paise Only) within 60 days from the date of receipt of the said notice. The borrower having failed to repay the amount, notice is hereby given to the borrower and the public in general that the undersigned has taken possession of the property described herein below in exercise of powers conferred on him/her under Section 13(4) of the said Act read with rule 8 of the said rules on this 22nd day of the July 2026. The borrower in particular and the public in general is hereby cautioned not to deal with the property and any dealings with the property will be subject to the charge of the Union Bank of India for an amount Rs.48,83,382.20 (Rupees Forty Eight Lacs Eighty Three Thousand Three Hundred Eighty Two and Twenty Paise Only) and interest thereon. The borrower's attention is invited to provisions of sub-section (8) of section 13 of the Act, of time available to the borrower to redeem the secured assets.

Description of Mortgage Immovable Property:

ALL THE PART AND PARCEL OF PROPERTY BEARING PROPERTY NO IX-5512-E, PART OF KHASRA NO 176 SITUATED AT GALI NO 06, RAGHUBARPURA NO 02, SEELAMPUR, GANDHINAGAR, DELHI, PIN-110031 CONSISTING OF TWO HALLS, ROOMS AND THREE SHOPS MEASURING 160 SQ.YARDS. BOUNDARIES OF THE PLOT: EAST: ENTRY TO THE PROPERTY THROUGH 15 FT WIDE ROAD WEST: PROPERTY OWNED BY JUBIR SINGH NORTH: PROPERTY OWNED BY SHRI KALU RAM SOUTH : 5 FT WIDE COMMON PASSAGE ACROSS WHICH PROPERTY OWNED BY SHRI JAGDISH

Date: 22.07.2026 Sd/- Authorised Officer Union Bank of India Place: New Delhi

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

Letter No.: DRMC/AGRA/NFR/E-AUCTION Dated: 24.07.2026

E-AUCTION NOTICE

On behalf of the President of India, The Sr. Divisional Commercial Manager-North Central Railway-Agra invites E-Auction as per category given as under:-

Category:	Misc-Static-Services	Catalogue No.:	NFR-AGRA-26-09
Asset Details	E-Auction Start Date and Time	E-Auction End Date and Time	
For Setup, Operation & Maintenance of Goodshed Canteen/Refreshment facility at Kuberpur Goodshed.	Date: 07.08.2026 Time: 11:00	Date: 07.08.2026 Time: 11:30	
For Setup, Operation & Maintenance of Goodshed Canteen/Refreshment facility at Mathura Goodshed.	Date: 07.08.2026 Time: 11:10	Date: 07.08.2026 Time: 11:40	
Millet Stall at Platform area of Dhaupur Railway Station.	Date: 07.08.2026 Time: 11:20	Date: 07.08.2026 Time: 12:00	
Millet Stall at Platform area of Kosikalan Railway Station.	Date: 07.08.2026 Time: 11:30	Date: 07.08.2026 Time: 12:00	
Millet Stall at Platform area of Hodal Railway Station.	Date: 07.08.2026 Time: 11:40	Date: 07.08.2026 Time: 12:10	
For Setup, Operation & Maintenance of Multi Functional Complex at Circulating area of MTJ 2 nd Entry.	Date: 07.08.2026 Time: 11:50	Date: 07.08.2026 Time: 12:20	
Category:	ADVT	Catalogue No.:	ADVT-IDH-26-06
Commercial publicity via Glowsign/ Board at Platform & Concourse area of Idghah Railway Station.	Date: 06.08.2026 Time: 11:00	Date: 06.08.2026 Time: 11:30	

Note:- Prospective bidders are requested to visit E-Auction Leasing Module on IREPS website (www.ireps.gov.in). The Lot-wise details are available therein under the above mentioned Catalogue Number. 1711/26 (PH)

North central railways @CPRONCR www.nccr.indianrailways.gov.in

NORTHERN RAILWAY

Ref:- i) Tender Notice No.21/2026-2027 Dated 19/06/2026. S.N.-02 ii) Tender No.07265050 due on 15/07/2026. In reference to above tender, the following corrigendum has been issued. (1) The tender opening date extended from 15/07/26 to 30/07/26 now same has been further extended 10/08/2026. (2). Eligibility criteria have been revised. (3). Availability of drawings at RCF website has been incorporated. All other terms and condition remain unchanged. The corrigendum has been published on website www.ireps.gov.in

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE 2588/26

NORTHERN RAILWAY

Tender Notice

Invitation of Tenders through E-Procurement System

Principal Chief Materials Manager, Northern Railway, New Delhi-110001 for and on behalf of the President of India, invites e-tenders through e-procurement system for supply of the following items:-

Sr. No.	Tender No.	Brief Description	Qty.	Closing Date
01	77265440	Driving Axle Set Complete	01 Nos	24.08.2026
02	19260696	Membrance For Hurth Coupling	430 Nos	24.08.2026
03	07265064	Yam Damper for VB Trainset	160 Nos	24.08.2026
04	08265350	RGC Tender for 6 Quad 0.9 MM Cable	3424.22 KM	31.08.2026
05	04265036	Servo Lube	130620 LTR	01.09.2026
06	02265214	Maintenance Free Valve Regulated Lead Acid Batteries Set For 110V	326 Set	07.09.2026
07	07262022	Lower Spring Beam for AC Coaches	200 Nos	09.09.2026
08	07261095	Guide with Closing Plate for Axle Box	3072 Nos	16.09.2026

Note: 1. Vendors may visit the IREPS website i.e. www.ireps.gov.in for details. 2. No manual offer will be entertained. Tender Notice No.29/2026-2027 Dated: 27.07.2026 2586/2026

Serving Customers With A Smile

COURT NOTICE (U/o 5 Rule 20 CPC) IN THE COURT OF Sh. Sanjay SDJM Samalkha Additional Civil Judge (Senior Division), Samalkha Mukesh Kumar Vs. Ram Dutt CNR No. HRPFAO-000539-2019 Next Date 07-08-2026 CS 418/2019

PUBLICATION ISSUED TO: 1.a Santosh widow of Ram Dutt 1.c Bindu daughter of Ram Dutt 1.d Neelam daughter of Ram Dutt 1.e Rajni daughter of Ram Dutt all residents of Village Jalalpur-I Tehsil Bapoli District Panipat In above titled case, the defendant (s)/ respondent(s) could not be served. It is ordered that defendant(s)/ respondent(s) should appear in person or through counsel on 07-08-2026 at 10:00 am. For details login to <https://highcourthd.gov.in/?mod=distnotic&district=Panipat> Sd/- Sh. Sanjay Additional Civil Judge (Senior Division), SDJM Dated 27.07-2026 Samalkha

OFFICE OF THE RESIDENT COMMISSIONER GOVT. OF MADHYA PRADESH, MADHYA PRADESH BHAWAN 29 C-D, JESUS & MARY MARG, CHANAKYAPUR, NEW DELHI-110021 Phone No. 011-26772001, 2002

Dated: 27/07/2026

CORRIGENDUM-I

The due dates for "Hiring Agencies for Taxi Services" for MP Bhawan & Madhyanchal, New Delhi 110021 against NIT No. 13/Hiring Taxi Services/MPB/2026 dated 06.07.2026 have been further extended as mentioned below:-

S.N.	Description	Existing date/ time	Extended date/ time
1.	Last date & time of Technical & Financial Bid submission	27.07.2026 upto 03.30 PM	03.08.2026 upto 03.30 PM
2.	Date & time of Opening of Technical Bid	28.07.2026 at 03.30 PM	04.08.2026 at 03.30 PM
3	Date & time of Opening of Financial Bid of qualified bidder	03.08.2026 at 03.30 PM	10.08.2026 at 03.30 PM

G16352/26 "स्वभाव स्वच्छता, संस्कार स्वच्छता" A.dl. Resident Commissioner M.T Bhawan, New Delhi

ALREADY SURPASSED 2013 LEVELS

India’s FCNR (B) inflows projected to touch \$80-85 bn: SBI Research

‘Deposit mobilization recorded \$17.4 bn for FCNR(B) flows, reflecting that exchange process at RBI by banks was happening gradually’

NEW DELHI: India may now receive Foreign Currency Non-Resident (Bank) deposits in the range of \$65-70 billion by the end of the scheme and overall \$80-\$85 billion, according to an SBI Research report. The total amount mobilized so far in 45 days has crossed the total amount mobilized in 2013 over a three-month period.

“Given the current trend we believe that total amount mobilized so far in 45 days has easily crossed the total amount mobilized in 2013 in 3 months! Overall, we believe, India may now receive FCNR (B) deposits in the range of \$65-70 billion by the end of the scheme and overall \$80-\$85 billion,” the SBI Research report stated.

The report noted that public sector banks served as the primary drivers of this mobilization. Citing data from the Reserve Bank of India (RBI), the report noted that FCNR(B) deposits worth \$17.41 billion were mobilized till July 17, 2026.

The total deposit inflows reached \$20.72 billion till July 17, which included \$1.97 bil-



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lion from Overseas Foreign Currency Borrowings (OFCBs) and \$1.34 billion from External Commercial Borrowings (ECBs).

The report mentioned that total FCNR deposits were expected to reach \$26-

28 billion by July 23 alone. SBI Research revised its total FCNR forecast at the end of the scheme upward to \$65-70 billion from an earlier estimate of \$40-45 billion.

“We also believe that significant majority of exist-

HIGHLIGHTS

- » The total deposit inflows reached \$20.72 billion till July 17, which included \$1.97 billion from OFCBs & \$1.34 bn from External Commercial Borrowings
- » The report mentioned that total FCNR deposits were expected to reach \$26-28 billion by July 23 alone
- » SBI Research revised its total FCNR forecast at the end of the scheme upward to \$65-70 billion from an earlier estimate of \$40-45 billion

ing FCNR deposits which are going to mature in Aug/ Sep’26 will be renewed under the new scheme (gravitated by higher interest rates) and will boost the FCNR (B) inflows,” the report added.

“Our preliminary estimate

indicate that amount worth \$10 billion on a conservative basis in addition to base line estimates are going to be mobilized mostly through those economies where tax concessions are available,” the report said.

Foreign Currency Assets (FCA) increased by \$7.6 billion from June 8 till July 17.

Meanwhile, deposit mobilization recorded \$17.4 billion for FCNR(B) flows, possibly reflecting that the exchange process at the RBI by the banks was happening gradually, accounting for roughly 44 per cent of the total amount.

“The next reporting for FCA for July is for week ended July 24 and week ended July 31 and we expect for the next 15 days period (17 Jul-31 Jul) FCA inflows could touch \$10-12 billion based on current trends,” the report said.

“This should make most of the overall FCA accruals/ growth (till July end) of \$17-20 billion post the RBI measures accounted for in RBI reserve data buoyed primarily by FCNR (B) inflows,” the report stated.

Markets snap 5-day fall, Sensex rises 776 pts on drop in oil prices

The market capitalisation of BSE-listed cos surged Rs 5,10,561.8 crore to Rs 4,80,80,037.04 crore (\$5 trillion)

OUR CORRESPONDENT

MUMBAI: Stock markets snapped the five-day losing streak on Monday, with the benchmark Sensex jumping by 776 points following a sharp decline in crude oil prices amid easing tensions in West Asia.

The 30-share BSE Sensex jumped 776.01 points, or 1.02 per cent, to settle at 76,835.78. During the day, it soared 841.74 points, or 1.10 per cent, to 76,901.51.

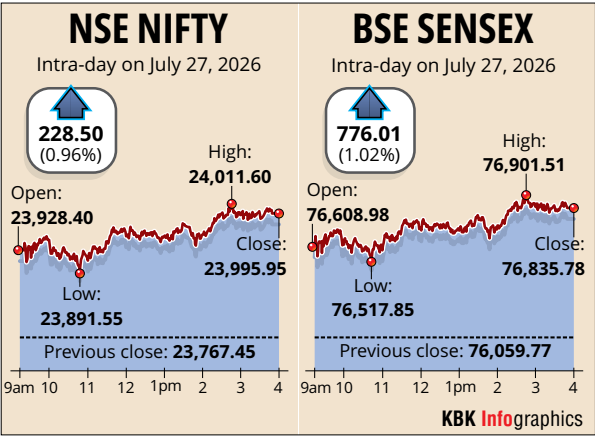
The 50-share NSE Nifty surged 228.50 points, or 0.96 per cent, to end at 23,995.95, ending its five-day losing trend.

The market capitalisation of BSE-listed companies surged Rs 5,10,561.8 crore to Rs 4,80,80,037.04 crore (\$5 trillion) following the rebound in equities.

Among Sensex firms, Eternal jumped the most by 5.70 per cent. InterGlobe Aviation, Infosys, Bajaj Finance, Asian Paints and Mahindra & Mahindra were also among the gainers. HDFC Bank, Power Grid and Axis Bank were the laggards.

Brent crude, the global oil benchmark, tanked 9.40 per cent to \$87.64 per barrel. FIIs offloaded equities worth Rs 3,892.77 crore on Friday, according to exchange data.

The BSE SmallCap Select index jumped 1.71 per cent and



MidSmall Pvt Banks Quality Tilt jumped 2.36%, followed by IT (2.30%), Realty (2.25%), Focused IT (2.09%), Services (2%), Auto (1.53%) & Hospitals (1.43%)

MidCap Select index climbed 1.65 per cent.

MidSmall Private Banks Quality Tilt jumped the most by 2.36 per cent, followed by IT (2.30 per cent), Realty (2.25 per cent), Focused IT (2.09 per cent), Services (2 per cent), Auto (1.53 per cent) and Hospitals (1.43 per cent). Telecom

emerged as the only laggard.

A total of 2,776 stocks advanced, while 1,580 declined and 202 remained unchanged on the BSE. In the last five trading days, the BSE benchmark tanked 2,091.68 points, or 2.67 per cent, and the Nifty declined 566.85 points, or 2.32 per cent.

In Asian markets, South Korea's KOSPI, Japan's Nikkei 225 index, Shanghai's SSE Composite index and Hong Kong's Hang Seng index ended higher. Markets in Europe were trading higher. US markets ended mostly higher.

On Friday, the Sensex declined 331.62 points, or 0.43 per cent, to settle at 76,059.77. The Nifty dipped 102.15 points, or 0.43 per cent, to end at 23,767.45.

Rupee rises 54 paise to 95.99 against dollar

MUMBAI: The rupee appreciated sharply by 54 paise to close at 95.99 against the US dollar on Monday, driven by a steep correction in crude oil prices after the US and Iran paused the war in West Asia, triggering hopes of easing global trade tensions.

According to forex traders, the local currency also found support from a firm trend in domestic equities and weakness in the US dollar against major currencies.

At the interbank foreign exchange, the rupee opened at 96.18 and touched the low of 96.27 and high of 95.78 against the greenback during the session.

The local unit finally settled at 95.99 against the dollar, up 54 paise compared to its previous closing level.

On Friday, the rupee recovered from its record low levels to settle 20 paise higher at 96.53 against the US dollar. The rupee's all-time low closing level of 96.86 was recorded on May 20.

Anuj Choudhary, Research Analyst, Mirae Asset ShareKhan, said the rupee strengthened to the highest levels in three weeks as the US and Iran halted strikes after two weeks of escalation.

“Falling crude oil prices and softening of the US dollar also favoured the rupee. Reports of intervention by the RBI also supported the rupee,” Choudhary said.

Meanwhile, the dollar index, which gauges the greenback's strength against a basket of six currencies, was trading 0.20 per cent lower at 101.09.

Number of people reporting income of over ₹100 cr rises 4-fold in 5 years

NEW DELHI: The number of individuals reporting a Gross Total Income (GTI) of Rs 100 crore or more in their Income Tax Returns (ITRs) has increased more than four-fold over the past five assessment years, the government informed Parliament on Monday.

Answering a question in Parliament, Minister of State for Finance Pankaj Chaudhary said 576 individuals reported a gross total income of Rs 100 crore or more in Assessment Year (AY) 2025-26, compared with 142 individuals in AY 2021-22.

The number stood at 301 in AY 2022-23, 284 in AY 2023-24 and 415 in AY 2024-25 before rising to 576 in AY 2025-26.

The minister clarified that there is no statutory definition of the term “billionaire” under the Income-tax Act, 2025 or the erstwhile Income-tax Act, 1961. He added that the government tracks individuals report-

ing gross total income of Rs 100 crore or more through income tax returns.

He stated, “There is no statutory definition of the term ‘billionaire’ either under the Income-tax Act, 2025 or under the erstwhile Income-tax Act, 1961.”

On whether the government maintains data on the aggregate wealth of billionaires, the minister said the Wealth-tax Act, 1957 was abolished with effect from April 1, 2016, and the government does not maintain data on the aggregate wealth of taxpayers.

The government also said that several indicators point towards improving economic inclusion. According to the latest Household Consumption Expenditure Survey 2023-24, the Gini coefficient declined to 0.237 in rural areas from 0.266 in 2022-23 and to 0.284 in urban areas from 0.314, indicating a

narrowing rural-urban gap.

The Gini coefficient is a statistical measure of economic inequality that ranges from 0 to 1, evaluating income or wealth distribution. A value of 0 indicates perfect equality, while 1 indicates complete inequality.

Further, the government said the unemployment rate for individuals aged 15 years and above declined from 3.6 per cent in 2022 to 3.1 per cent in 2025, while multidimensional poverty has also fallen significantly over the past decade, according to NTI Ayog.

The minister said the government continues to promote inclusive economic growth through a progressive income tax structure, employment-linked tax incentives, support for start-ups and cooperatives, and welfare programmes covering housing, healthcare, financial inclusion, skill development and rural livelihoods.

Hudco June qtr profit zooms 35% to ₹851 crore

NEW DELHI: Housing and Urban Development Corporation Ltd (Hudco) on Monday reported a 35 per cent jump in net profit to Rs 851 crore in the first quarter ended June 2026.

The state-owned company had earned a net profit of Rs 630 crore in the year-ago period. The company's total income rose to Rs 3,737 crore in the first quarter of this fiscal year from Rs 2,945 crore in the corresponding period of the preceding year, Hudco said in a regulatory filing.

Hudco is a premier technofinancing public sector enterprise in the field of housing and infrastructure development.

The company earned an interest income of Rs 3,710

crore during the quarter under review as against Rs 2,925 crore in the April-June quarter of the previous financial year.

During the reporting quarter, the expenses also rose to Rs 2,561 crore against Rs 1,976 crore in the same period a year ago. The company has declared the first interim dividend of Rs 1.25 per equity share, which is 12.50 per cent on the face value of Rs 10 each, for the financial year 2026-27.

The company has made provisions on loans (impairment) based on the expected credit loss (ECL) method amounting to Rs 621 crore as on June 30, 2026 (compared to Rs 1702.89 crore as on June 30, 2025), it said.

Over 4 cr ITRs filed for AY 2026-27

NEW DELHI: More than 4 crore income tax returns (ITRs) have been filed for Assessment Year 2026-27, as per the Income Tax Department.

The I-T Department has urged taxpayers to file their ITR-1 and ITR-2 returns ahead of the July 31, 2026 deadline to avoid last-minute rush and stress. “Over 4 Crore ITRs for AY 2026-27 filed and counting! Avoid the 31 July, 2026 deadline stress and file your ITR 1 & 2 early,” IT-Department said in a statement on X.

Last week, the Union Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman highlighted record ITR filings and improvements in grievance redressal. FM had also urged the I-Tax Department to expedite refund processing to strengthen taxpayer

confidence and enhance ease of compliance.

Addressing the 167th Income Tax Day celebrations, the first since the “Income Tax Act, 2025” came into force, Sitharaman stressed the Department's role has expanded beyond revenue collection to include fairness, ease of doing business and citizen-centric service delivery. She outlined 5Rs of responsive tax governance.

She further said that the ongoing income tax filing season has achieved several significant milestones, with the e-Filing portal handling more than one crore taxpayer interactions in a single day following enhancements to its computing capacity and bandwidth.

Peak daily interactions reached nearly 1.6 crore. As of

July 21, more than 3.2 crore Income Tax Returns (ITRs) had been filed, of which 94 per cent had been verified and 60 per cent processed.

Highlighting improvements in grievance redressal, Sitharaman said the Department resolved 94 per cent of nearly 78,000 grievances received through the Centralised Public Grievance Redress and Monitoring System (CPGRAMS) during FY 2025-26.

The average disposal time was reduced from 57 days to 28 days, while nearly two-thirds of the complaints were resolved within three weeks. She added that on the e-Nivaran platform, 95 per cent of around 3.5 lakh grievances had been disposed of, with the average resolution time falling to 42 days.

Recent withdrawl of FPIs part of broader emerging mkt trend, not India-specific: Govt

‘Changes in FPI investments driven by mix of domestic, global factors’

NEW DELHI: The government on Monday said the recent withdrawal of foreign portfolio investments (FPIs) from Indian equities was part of a broader trend across emerging markets and was “not altogether specific to India,” attributing the movement to a mix of global and domestic factors.

In a written reply in the Lok Sabha, Minister of State for Finance Pankaj Chaudhary said, “The recent foreign portfolio outflows from Indian

equities are part of a broader pattern noticed in emerging markets and not altogether specific to India.”

He added that changes in FPI investments have been driven by “a mix of domestic and global factors such as geopolitical tensions, uncertainties surrounding trade tariffs, global investor sentiments, currency movements and portfolio rebalancing by global funds across emerging markets.”

According to data cited in

the reply from the National Securities Depository Limited (NSDL), FPIs were net sellers of Rs 1,52,691.04 crore during 2025-26, compared with net inflows of Rs 20,019.66 crore in 2024-25 and Rs 3,39,064.57 crore in 2023-24.

“Despite FPI outflows, overall investor sentiment remains intact, as evidenced by the holdings of domestic institutional investors (DIIs), particularly mutual funds, in listed Indian companies,” the minister said. The reply also

noted that FPIs have “shown confidence in the Indian stock market consistently over the years,” with gross purchases rising from Rs 23,87,375.71 crore in 2021-22 to Rs 44,64,817.84 crore in 2025-26.

On the impact of foreign fund withdrawals on the rupee, the government said exchange rate movements are influenced by several domestic and global factors, including the Dollar Index, capital flows, interest rates, crude oil prices and the current account deficit.

Chirag Paswan celebrates mango farmers with Anandana – The Coca-Cola India Foundation

NEW DELHI: India's home-grown billion-dollar fruit-based drink, Maaza celebrates 50 years of its journey in country. Anandana – The Coca-Cola India Foundation, honoured the mango farmers behind the brand's legacy through its flagship agriculture initiative, Project Unnati which supports mango farmers with modern cultivation practices to improve productivity, fruit quality and efficient water use.

Marking National Mango Day, the event included the release of a ‘Special Cover’ in collaboration with Department of Posts. Chirag Paswan, Union Minister of Food Processing



Industries along with Col. Akhilesh Kumar Pandey, Chief Postmaster General, Delhi Circle, Department of Posts, Ministry of Communications released the Special Cover.

Farmers from various parts of country were felicitated in the presence of Coca-Cola India

leadership, bottling partners, implementation partner CEN-DECT and mango supplier Foods & Inns Ltd.

Devyani Rana, Vice President – Public Affairs, Communications & Sustainability, Coca-Cola India & South West Asia, said “Behind every bot-

tle of Maaza - one of India's most loved fruit-based drinks is the dedication and expertise of India's mango farming communities. Through Anandana's Project Unnati, we have been working alongside farmers and our implementation partners to strengthen productivity, improve fruit quality, and promote more resilient farming practices. As Maaza celebrates 50 years, it is equally a celebration of the farmers whose commitment has helped shape India's mango heritage. We remain committed to supporting their journey through sustainable agriculture and long-term partnerships.”

THE GROUP'S REVENUE ROSE BY 7.8%, WHILE PAT GREW BY 51.9% IN FY26

Tata Group reports FY26 revenue of ₹16,24,030 cr, PAT of ₹1,70,525 cr

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Tata Group's revenue at the aggregate level grew by 7.8 per cent to Rs 16,24,030 crore in FY26, while profit after tax grew 51.9 per cent to Rs 1,70,525 crore, according to its chief N Chandrasekaran.

In his address to shareholders in the annual report 2025-26 of Tata Sons, the principal investment holding firm of the Tata Group companies, Chandrasekaran said, "2026 has been a year defined by geopolitical conflicts and the unprecedented global AI investment cycle".

For the Tata Group, (FY)2026 overall has been a good year in terms of financial metrics, he noted.

"Tata Sons' revenue grew by 9.1 per cent to Rs 42,367 crore in FY26, while profits (after tax) grew 21.8 per cent to Rs 31,961 crore," Chandrasekaran said, adding the board of Tata Sons has recommended a final dividend of Rs 1,10,717 per share, subject to shareholders' approval.

He further said, "At the aggregate level, the revenue of the Tata Group grew by 7.8 per cent to Rs 16,24,030 crore in FY26, while profits (after tax) grew 51.9 per cent to Rs 1,70,525 crore."

Chandrasekaran noted that the FY26 "revenue is 2.1x and



'Tata Sons' revenue grew by 9.1% to Rs 42,367 crore in FY26, while PAT grew 21.8% to Rs 31,961 crore'

profits are 5.4x their FY20 levels, reflecting sustained and significant turnaround efforts across the institution".

"All of our established businesses delivered strong performances this year, both in terms of revenue and profits," he said, while stating that the group's British luxury carmaker JLR suffered a cyberattack in Q2 FY26 which resulted in a production pause for five weeks, although it has recovered with Q4 closing at near-normal production levels.

In his letter, Chandrasekaran updated shareholders on the group's new ventures such as Tata Electronics, Tata Digital, Air India and Agra-

KEY POINTS

» Chandrasekaran said Tata Electronics is on track to become the first integrated player across electronics value chain

» 'In four years, it has become the fourth-largest Tata Group company by revenue — Rs 1,31,082 crore'

» Given where it began, he said, "Air India's transformation must be seen as a five- to ten-year journey, Chandrasekaran said

tas, among others, which as per reports, have come under the scanner of Tata Trusts Chairman Noel Tata.

Reflecting how the founders of the Tata Group took bets that "looked audacious, even imprudent, at the time they were made" but "turned out to be exactly what the nation needed", he asserted that the "institutions we are seeding now (are) with long gestation periods".

He cited examples of the Indian Institute of Science, the group's forays into steel and aviation, the Tata Institute of Fundamental Research, software services and international expansion to underscore the

long-term bets that the conglomerate took since the time of its founders.

Stating that the next industrial revolution is being designed and built right now, and its building blocks are silicon, connectivity, energy and security, Chandrasekaran said Tata Electronics is on track to become the first integrated player across the electronics value chain.

"In four years, it has become the fourth-largest Tata Group company by revenue — Rs 1,31,082 crore — and nearly two-thirds of its workforce of 86,466 consists of women. Operating profits have already achieved breakeven. The company manufactured 12 per cent of the total volume of phones made by the global leader in 2025," Chandrasekaran said.

Stressing that chips are the new steel, he said every phone, car, aircraft, hospital, power grid, and AI system runs on them. A nation that cannot make its own semiconductors will always depend on others for the most fundamental input of the modern economy."

"These are among the most complex manufacturing endeavours humanity has attempted, and they demand patient capital, global partnerships, thousands of highly trained engineers, and years of disciplined execution. We

are building not just plants, but an ecosystem: suppliers, talent pipelines, research linkages. When the first "Made in India" chips flow at scale, they will do exactly what is needed for India's technology sovereignty," he said.

On Tata Digital, he said it has navigated multiple complexities across its businesses.

"The Indian e-commerce market shifted rapidly towards quick commerce, which Big-Basket is adapting to. In FY26, Tata Digital reported a loss of Rs 4,974 crore. But Tata Digital's ambitions are great and are beginning to show progress. It has scaled to a GMV of Rs 46,515 crore within four years of launch," he noted.

In aviation, Chandrasekaran said, "Rebuilding Air India is a long journey: fleet renewal, training, service transformation, network expansion. Every great airline in history was built over decades, not quarters. Significant progress has been made in the transformation journey."

Given where it began, he said, "Air India's transformation must be seen as a five- to ten-year journey, considering the years-long supply chain disruptions in key components, the need to overhaul legacy systems, culture and fleet, and the creation of a large cadre of technical and airline professionals."

HDFC Bank levies ₹1L fine on MD, CFO, group head in MSRDC case

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The board of HDFC Bank has imposed a monetary penalty of Rs 1 lakh on the bank's three top executives — Managing Director and CEO Sashidhar Jagdishan, Chief Financial Officer (CFO) Srinivasan Vaidyanathan and Group Head (Retail Assets) Arvind Vohra — for divergence from RBI direction in the Maharashtra State Road Development Corporation (MSRDC) case.

Besides, warning letters were issued to the remaining employees involved in the case related to garnering large deposits from MSRDC between 2017 and 2021 by allegedly paying about Rs 45 crore under the marketing spends head.

The action comes soon after the appointment of former Chief Election Commissioner and Finance Secretary Rajiv Kumar as part-time chairman of the bank.

Reserve Bank approved Kumar's three-year appointment as chairman of the bank effective from July 15, 2026.

HDFC Bank in a regulatory filing said based on the findings and recommendation of the Special Disciplinary Committee of Independent Directors, the board at its meeting held on July 23, 2026, concluded that the conduct of the employees involved constituted business overreach rather than any mala fide action, personal enrichment, or improper motive.

"However, keeping in view



Besides, warning letters were issued to the remaining employees involved in the case related to garnering large deposits from MSRDC between 2017 and 2021

any potential divergence with the applicable RBI Directions and based on the recommendations of the Special Disciplinary Committee of Independent Directors, the board decided to issue warning letters and monetary penalty of Rs 1 lakh for three senior employees (the Managing Director & CEO, Chief Financial Officer and Group Head – Retail Assets), and warning letters for the remaining employees," it said.

The board further directed that the matter be communicated to the Reserve Bank of India, it said.

Rejecting any wrongdoing in the matter, HDFC Bank's spokesperson in May had said its internal oversight and audit mechanisms are robust and

HIGHLIGHTS

» The action comes soon after the appointment of former Chief Election Commissioner and Finance Secretary Rajiv Kumar as part-time chairman of the bank

» The board at its meeting held on July 23, concluded that the conduct of employees involved constituted biz overreach rather than any mala fide action

» The board further directed that the matter be communicated to the Reserve Bank of India

that all matters are handled as per established procedures.

All issues are dealt with in accordance with the bank's established norms, and the full process is always followed before final determination post any internal review, the spokesperson had said in a statement.

"We strongly reject any assumptions of wrongdoing or culpability based on selective material," the statement added.

The clarification was issued after media reports claimed that the bank's audit committee had initiated a formal 'internal vigilance investigation' into payments totalling Rs 45 crore to MSRDC that were allegedly disguised as marketing expenditure.

Beverage makers denied FSSAI relief on energy drink misbranding

NEW DELHI: Food regulator FSSAI has provided 90 days to beverage companies, including PepsiCo and Reliance Retail, to comply with its order to remove the misleading 'energy drinks' claim from their products, according to sources.

On July 1, the FSSAI had issued notices to six beverage firms that sell energy drinks for misbranding and misleading

claims. The regulator had said it has not framed any standard for the energy drink category.

The six brands are — Red Bull Energy Drink, PepsiCo's Adrenaline Rush Energy Drink, Reliance Consumer Products' 'Campa Energy Drink- Gold Boost', Sting Energy Drink, Hell Energy and Coca-Cola-backed Monster Energy.

According to sources, lead-

ing energy drink makers under the banner of the Indian Beverage Association (IBA) held a meeting last Friday with the FSSAI CEO and other officials regarding the notices issued by the authority.

In this meeting, food safety officials from some states, including Gujarat and Maharashtra, were also present. Sources said the industry

failed to get any reprieve from the FSSAI.

The regulator has provided 90 days for compliance with its order, which is the removal of the term 'Energy Drink,' they added.

The industry sought time to arrange new packaging material.

While issuing notice on July 1, FSSAI noted that it

has not notified any standard for "Energy Drink" or similar products. The regulator had stated that these brands have "marketed using descriptors such as energy drink on product branding and labelling".

The FSSAI had further said that the Food Category System under the FSS Regulations is not intended for product nam-

ing or labelling purposes.

"Functional or therapeutic claims, including but not limited to 'vitalises body and mind', 'enhancing focus', 'boost energy levels', 'aid in general weakness', or similar conditions, are not permissible for food products under the FSS Act 2006 and the Rules and Regulations made thereunder," the regulator said. PTI

Govt plans 3-year PUCC validity for BS-VI vehicles

NEW DELHI: The government has proposed to extend the validity of the Pollution Under Control Certificate (PUCC) for up to six-year-old Bharat Stage-VI (BS-VI)-compliant private vehicles to three years instead of the current one year to ease the burden on owners.

The Ministry of Road Transport and Highways (MoRTH), in a draft notification, has said that BS-VI vehicles aged between six and ten years will be required to renew their Pollution Under Control Certificate and those above 10 years every six years. PTI

Sport

Lifting Indian spirits

Mirabai-inspired Gyaneshwari bags CWG silver with a personal-best 199kg

S KANNAN

GLASGOW: There is a divine touch about Gyaneshwari Devi, the 23-year-old weightlifter from Chattisgarh. On Monday, the calm girl showed nerves of steel to win a silver medal in the 53kg category as she totalled 199kg (88kg snatch, 11kg clean and jerk. In a packed hall, where Nigeria's Onome Omolola Didih was in smashing form, the Indian soaked in the pressure well.

Having started her career in powerlifting, Gyaneshwari made the transition a few years back. She had won a medal in the Asian Championship held in Ahmedabad earlier this year. This was her big stage, Glasgow, where a good showing was important for her. As one who has taken inspiration from Mirabai Chanu, Gyaneshwari wanted to do well. "Didi is my role model and I am so happy I won silver. I gave my best shot and this medal is important for India and all those who believed in me," she said.

Appearing before the media, she had the Indian tri colours pinned as hair clips and sported a 'bindi' on her forehead. That was after she said a quick prayer post competition. Asked about the emotions which played out, Gyaneshwari



Gyaneshwari Yadav lifted a total of 199kg (88kg snatch + 111kg clean and jerk)

was all smiles.

"This is my first Commonwealth Games medal. My main goal was to achieve my personal best, which I achieved. I tried hard to go for gold," added the cherubic girl.

Asked about her preparation for this Games and what lies ahead, Gyaneshwari opened up. "The preparations were great. We were training in Birmingham before coming to Glasgow. That was, indeed, very beneficial," she said.

Gyaneshwari equalled her personal best in the snatch (88kg)

Competing in the 49kg section, a category which belongs to Mirabai, Gyaneshwari said this was special. "Yesterday when Didi won a gold medal, it was a big motivation for me. I take inspiration from her and compete. Today I wish to thank

my family, my coaches and all those who have showered love on me and have faith in me," said Gyaneshwari.

Asked about maintaining her weight, with a specific reference to hardships which Mirabai has faced to stay inside the 48 kg limit for her event in Glasgow, Gyaneshwari said she had no problems. "My body weight is well maintained and I did not have to do anything drastic to cut weight," she said. She will be making a shift to

the 53kg category for the Asian Games in Nagoya, Japan. "I will try and do my best at the Asian Games, which will be a first for me. What is important, I train hard and stay confident," added Gyaneshwari.

Asked about her diet and support, Gyaneshwari thanked the Sports Authority of India and TOPS (Target Olympic Podium Scheme). I train at the NIS camp in Patiala and everything is taken care of there. I am thankful to them," she said.

Bindyarani bags bronze

GLASGOW: India's Bindyarani Devi made a gritty fight but two unsuccessful clean and jerk attempts restricted her to bronze as Nigeria's Rafiatu Folashade Lawal powered to a record-breaking gold in the women's 58kg weightlifting event at the Commonwealth Games here on Monday. Bindyarani, who had won silver in the 55kg category at the 2022 Birmingham Games, finished with a total lift of 199kg (87kg snatch + 112kg clean and jerk) to secure the third spot.

The gap between the Indian and the top two lifters, however, was significant.

World championships silver medallist Lawal was in a class of her own, rewriting the record books with a Commonwealth and Games record of 103kg in the snatch, followed by another Games record of 126kg in the clean and jerk for a staggering total of 229kg. AGENCIES

PTI

Shirse in 110m hurdles final; Sreeshankar enters final

GLASGOW: M Sreeshankar qualified for the men's long jump final by breaching the automatic qualifying standard, while Lokesh Sathyanathan advanced on the basis of his top-12 finish at the Commonwealth Games here on Monday.

Sreeshankar, whose season's best is 8.38 metres, jumped 8.01m here to earn direct qualification from Group A. The qualification standard has been set at 8m or at least the 12 best performers. Competing in Group B, Sathyanathan managed a jump of 7.77m in his first attempt.

National record holder Tejas Shirse became the first Indian to qualify for the men's 110m hurdles final at the CWG, finishing sixth overall in the heats with a timing of 13.76 seconds. The 24-year-old Shirse finished third in Heat 1, which was topped by overall leader Samuel Bennett of England with a timing of 13.20sec.

Meanwhile, boxer Sachin Siwach and rising youngster Ankush advanced to the quarter-finals of the men's 60kg and 80kg categories.

India's Protistha Samanta finished seventh in the women's vault final of artistic gymnastics. The 22-year-old from West Bengal averaged 12.883. AGENCIES

VVS hails Vaibhav's rise in maturity, game awareness

HARARE: Impressed with Vaibhav Sooryavanshi's temperament, India's interim head coach VVS Laxman says the teenager's game awareness has "skyrocketed" in the last six months and he is becoming increasingly adept at handling pressure situations.

The 15-year-old prodigal talent capped a memorable tour of Zimbabwe by winning both the Player of the Match and Player of the Series awards as India completed a 3-0 sweep with a 35-run victory in the final T20I here on Sunday.

"What is really impressive is the way he's evolved as a person. The maturity level, the understanding, and the awareness over the last six months has actually skyrocketed. And that's why he's been able to handle tough situations," said Laxman, during the post-match press conference.

Sooryavanshi made 151 runs in three innings at an average of 50.33, with his sparkling 81 in the series finale laying the foundation for India's victory.

This came after the teenager endured a forgettable debut series against England, managing scores of 13, 14 and 15 before being dropped from the fifth and final T20I as India slumped to a 0-4 series defeat.



Vaibhav Sooryavanshi scored 81 in the third T20I vs Zimbabwe AP

Asked whether he expected such a strong comeback, Laxman said he never doubted the teenager's ability to bounce back because he had repeatedly shown the temperament to thrive under pressure in the IPL. "It (performance) was on expected lines...last year when he played for Rajasthan Royals for the first time, I think the way he handled pressure, because I believe that any IPL match is equivalent to an international match," he said. "And at the age of 14 or 15, when you're playing an IPL match, either you can be overawed by the big occasion or absorb and embrace the pressure." AGENCIES

Inspired by Bekauri, Tokas eyes first CWG judo gold

NEW DELHI: Drawn to combat sports since childhood and inspired by two-time Olympic champion Lasha Bekauri of Georgia, Indian judoka Harsh Tokas is dreaming of creating history by winning India's first ever Commonwealth Games gold medal in judo on his debut in Glasgow.

The 23-year-old, who will compete in the men's 81kg category, discovered judo at the age of 10 after joining a free acad-



emy in Delhi's Munirka village.

More than a decade later, the Commonwealth Games represent the biggest stage of his career, and Tokas is determined to settle for nothing less than the top step of the podium. "I started judo about 12 years ago when I was around 10 or 11 years old. I am from Munirka village in Delhi. There is an academy in our village run by our coach, he opened it for children free of cost so that anyone could come and train. That

is where my journey began," he told PTI during an interaction.

"I liked combat sports from a young age. There was a judo academy near my home and the environment attracted me. I used to enjoy competing and challenging myself, and that is how my judo career started," he added. "The only thing on my mind is to win a gold medal. I want to win a gold medal for my country and make everyone proud." AGENCIES

MANU CLAIMS BRONZE

Esha shoots down 25m pistol gold at World Cup

HANGZHOU: The fast-rising Esha Singh grabbed the gold by upstaging Olympic-medallist Manu Bhaker, who took the bronze to complete a double-podium finish for India in the women's 25m pistol event of the ISSF World Cup (Rifle/Pistol/Shotgun) on Monday.

The 21-year-old Esha produced a commanding display in the final, registering 40 hits



to seal the gold medal, while Paris 2024 double Olympic-

medallist Manu fought through a tense, highly-competitive field, winning a crucial shoot-off before finishing with 28 hits to secure bronze.

Reflecting on overcoming the mental pressure following her record-setting World Cup gold in Munich earlier this season, Esha said, "This match was very pressure-riding for me because of the previous medal I

had. The better you get in your event, the more you feel that weight of prestige you have to conquer. I'm happy that I was able to get past it today and grateful that I had the ability to endure it. I really love competing here in Hangzhou. Recalling how the competition went during the Asian Games, where I won four medals, I was really excited to come back." AGENCIES

S. E. RAILWAY – TENDER

For & on behalf of the President of India, Senior Divisional Electrical Engineer, Electric Loco Shed, Rourkela, S. E. Railway, invites E-Tender for the below mentioned work. Manual offers are not allowed against the tender, and any such manual offer received, shall be ignored : IREPS Tender No. : TRS-ROU-05-2026-27; Description of work : "Repair/ Reconditioning of Auxiliary Motors of WAG-9 type 3-phase electric locomotives"; Approx. Cost of Work : ₹ 1,39,72,690.38; Earnest Money : ₹ 2,79,500.00; Date & time for closing of E-Tender : 11:00 hrs. of 20.08.2026; Website Particulars & Details : <https://www.ireps.gov.in/> The complete particulars of the E-Tender will be available on aforementioned websites. (PR-528)

JHARKHAND URBAN INFRASTRUCTURE DEVELOPMENT COMPANY LIMITED
(Govt. of Jharkhand Undertaking)
JUIDCO Bhawan, KUTCHERY ROAD, RANCHI, JHARKHAND
Ph.No.: +91-651-2225878, e-mail Id-juidcolimited@gmail.com, CIN: U45200JH2013SGC001752
PR No.:383923
Tender ID: 2026_UDD_115912_1
This is for information of all the bidders that following Corrigendum is being made in tender documents for "Construction of Municipal Building at Chhatarpur under Chhatarpur Nagar Panchayat".
The bidders are advised to take into account the following Corrigendum before submission of their bids against this tender.

Corrigendum - 1				
Sl. No.	Bid Document Ref.	Description	As per RFP Document	As per Corrigendum - 1
1.	NIT	Last Date & Time of submission of Bid, Tender Fee and EMD online	28/07/2026 at 17:00 Hrs	04/08/2026 at 17:00 Hrs
2.		Date & Time of Bid Opening	29/07/2026 at 17:00 Hrs	05/08/2026 at 17:00 Hrs

Note: Other terms and conditions remain unchanged.
Sd/-
Project Director (Technical)
JUIDCO Ltd.
PR 385960 Urban Development and Housing(26-27).D

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.
Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Sunil Kumar, R/o: Saroj Niwas 125/3, 3rd Floor, Gali No. 3, East Moti Bagh, Sarai Rohila, New Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **CC No. 2231/22, U/s: 138 NI Act, Police Station Mukherjee Nagar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Sunil Kumar** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Sunil Kumar** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).
Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Sunil Kumar of Police Station Mukherjee Nagar, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **24.09.2026**.
By Order
Sh. Gaurav Dahiya
JMFC (NI Act), First Floor, Room No. 118,
Rohini Courts, Delhi
DP/10262/NW/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(See Section 82 Cr. P.C./84 BNSS)
Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused **Mr. Sushil Kumar Gupta R/o H. No. 705/5, Ward III, Mehrauli, New Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 183/2012 U/s 406/409/420/34 IPC, PS Sarojini Nagar, Delhi** and it has been returned to warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said accused **Mr. Sushil Kumar Gupta** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Mr. Sushil Kumar Gupta** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of said warrant).
Proclamation is hereby made that **Mr. Sushil Kumar Gupta in FIR No. 183/2012 U/s 406/409/420/34 IPC, PS Sarojini Nagar, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **29.08.2026**.
By order
Ms. Vijayshree Rathore
Judicial Magistrate First Class-05
Court No. 13
Patiala House Courts, New Delhi
DP/10233/SW/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(See Section 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita)
Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Gagan, S/o Birju Nath R/o H.No.15/B-42, Indra Vikas Colony, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No.453/21 u/s 392/411/34 IPC, P.S. Mukherjee Nagar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Gagan** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Gagan** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).
Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Gagan of FIR No.453/21 u/s 392/411/34 IPC, P.S. Mukherjee Nagar, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **02.09.2026**.
By Order,
Ms. Amardeep Kaur
Ld. ACJM (N)
Room No.117, Rohini Courts, Delhi
DP/10253/NW/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(SEE SECTION 82(2) (ii) Cr.P.C.)
Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person(s) **DEVENDER KUMAR S/o Deva Nath R/o F-139, Mangolpuri, Delhi** has committed (or are suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No./CC No. 1013/20, U/s 129/55 Gambling Act, PS Mangolpuri, Outer Distt., Delhi** and it has been returned to a Warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **DEVENDER KUMAR** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **DEVENDER KUMAR** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).
Proclamation are hereby made that the said accused person(s) **DEVENDER KUMAR of FIR No./CC No. 1013/20, U/s 129/55 Gambling Act, PS Mangolpuri, Outer Distt., Delhi** are required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before dated **29.08.2026 at 10:00 AM**.
By Order
Ms. Reetika Jain
Ld. Judicial Magistrate First Class
(Court Matter) (N-W) Room No. 105, Rohini Courts, Delhi
DP/10287/OD/2026

COURT NOTICE (U/o 5 Rule 20 CPC) IN THE COURT OF Sh. Sanjay SDJM Samalkha Additional Civil Judge (Senior Division), Samalkha POOJA Vs. GENERAL PUBLIC CNR No. HRPPAO-000792-2025 Next Date 03-08-2026 GW 23/2025 PUBLICATION ISSUED TO: General Public -> SAMALKHA In above titled case, the defendant (s)/ respondent(s) could not be served. It is ordered that defendant(s)/ respondent(s) should appear in person or through counsel on 03-08-2026 at 10:00 am. For details logon to https://highcourthd.gov.in/?mod=district_notice&district=Panipat Sd/- Sh. Sanjay Additional Civil Judge (Senior Division), SDJM Samalkha Dated 27-07-2026	COURT NOTICE (U/o 5 Rule 20 CPC) IN THE COURT OF Sh. Sohan Lal Malik Additional Civil Judge (Senior Division), Bhiwani VIJAY PAL SINGH VS. HOUSING BOARD CNR No. HRBH02-002786-2025 Next Date 18-09-2026 PUBLICATION ISSUED TO: GENERAL PUBLIC -> GENERAL PUBLIC In above titled case, the defendant (s)/ respondent(s) could not be served. It is ordered that defendant(s)/ respondent(s) should appear in person or through counsel on 18-09-2026 at 10:00 am. For details logon to https://highcourthd.gov.in/?mod=district_notice&district=Bhiwani Sd/- Sh. Sohan Lal Malik Additional Civil Judge (Senior Division) Bhiwani Dated 27-07-2026
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PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023
Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused 1. **Dev @ Duggi, S/o: Subhash, R/o: H.No-10985, Pipal Wali Gali, Motiya Khan, Delhi 2. Kake @ Punjabi @ Yogesh, S/o: Rajesh, R/o: H.No-2777, Basti Jhulan, Sadar Bazar, Delhi** have committed (or are suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No.: 268/2022, U/s: 379/411/34 IPC, P.S. Kashmere Gate, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said 1. **Dev @ Duggi, 2. Kake @ Punjabi @ Yogesh** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said 1. **Dev @ Duggi, 2. Kake @ Punjabi @ Yogesh** have absconded (or are concealing themselves to avoid the service of the said warrant).
Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused 1. **Dev @ Duggi, 2. Kake @ Punjabi @ Yogesh of P.S. Kashmere Gate, Delhi** are required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **14.09.2026**.
By Order
Sh. Vaibhav Garg
Ld. JMFC-11, Central, Ist Floor, Room No. 138,
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi
DP/9731/N/2026

Indian Bank STRESSED ASSETS MANAGEMENT BRANCH - CHENNAI
55, Ethiraj Salai, Zonal Office Building II Floor, Wellington Estate, Egmore, Chennai - 600 008. Telephone : 044-28216711. email : arm3chennai@indianbank.bank.in
Without Prejudice to the rights of the secured creditor/Bank the possession notice issued on 05.03.2024 and consequent actions under SARFAESI Act for the exposure of Mr. V. Bhaskar and Mr. V. Nandakumar (Home Loan A/c No.6803398506) stands withdrawn. In lieu of the same, the present possession notice is issued.
POSSESSION NOTICE (for immovable property)

Whereas the Undersigned being the Authorized Officer of the Indian Bank under the Securitization and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act 2002 and in exercise of powers conferred under the Section 13 (12) read with Rule 8 and 9 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002 issued Demand Notice dated **14.09.2023**, calling upon the Borrower(s) & Guarantor(s) : **(1) Mr. V. Bhaskar, (Borrower)**, No.B-138, First Floor, Chittaranjan Park, Near Market 3, Kalkaji, South Delhi, Delhi - 110 019, **(2) Mr. V. Nandakumar**, W-506, First Floor, C Sector 10th Street, Anna Nagar West Extension, Chennai - 600 101, **Also at** : Flat No.1510, 15th Floor, Seventh Block, Silver Oak Alliance Orchid Springs, No.54, Water Canal Road, Korattur, Chennai - 600 076, to repay the amount mentioned in the notice being **Rs.2,14,48,468/- (Rupees Two crores fourteen lakhs forty eight thousand four hundred and sixty eight only)** as on **13.09.2023** together with interest from 14.09.2023 till date of payment within 60 days from the date of receipt of the said notice.

The amount due by all the above as on **27.07.2026** is **Rs.2,85,18,283.20 (Rupees Two crores eighty five lakhs eighteen thousand two hundred eighty three and paise twenty only)** with further interest, costs, charges and expenses thereon.
The Borrower & Guarantors having failed to repay the amount, notice is hereby given to the Borrowers & Guarantors and the public in general that the undersigned has taken possession of the property described herein below in exercise of powers conferred on him under Section 13 (4) of the said Act read with rule 8 and 9 of the said rules on this **27th day of July 2026**.
The Borrowers/Guarantors/Mortgagors in particular and the public in general are hereby cautioned not to deal with the property and any dealings with the property will be subject to the charge of Indian Bank for an amount of **Rs.2,85,18,283.20 (Rupees Two crores eighty five lakhs eighteen thousand two hundred eighty three and paise twenty only)** as on **27.07.2026** payable by you with further interest from 28.07.2026 costs, charges, expenses etc., thereon. **"We draw attention to the provisions of Section 13(8) of the SARFAESI Act and the Rules framed there under which deals with your rights of redemption over the securities".**

DESCRIPTION OF THE IMMOVABLE PROPERTY
The specific details of the assets in which security interest is created are enumerated hereunder:
All that piece and parcel of land with building measuring 5790 Sq. ft. together with building measuring 3028 Sq. ft. Ground and First Floor with all fixtures and fittings thereon along with a easementary right of absolute necessity for ingress and egress of common passage from the road leading from Kodaikanal - Vilpatti Road, at Villipati village, Kodaikanal Taluk, Dindigul District, Old Survey No.1407/2, New Survey No.1407/2C1A, 1407/2C1C & 1407/2C1C1, Patta No 9076. New Survey No.1407/5 and bounded on the North by : Common Road, East by : Remaining land with building in Survey No.1407/5, South by : Property belongs to Karupaiah, West by : Survey No.1409. Within the Sub-Registration District of Kodaikanal and Registration District of Dindigul and within the limits of Vilpatti Panchyat.
Date : 27.07.2026
Place : Kodaikanal
Authorised Officer,
Indian Bank, SAM Branch, Chennai.

UJVN LIMITED
H.O.: "UJJWAL", Maharani Bagh, G.M.S. Road, Dehradun-248006
Telephones: 0135-2763808, Fax: 0135-2763508
CIN No. U40101UR2013SGC025866 Website: www.ujvn.com
Letter No: 621 E-Tender Notice Date: 27/07/2026
Office of the Executive Engineer (Civil), Pashulok Barrage, Rishikesh invites online bids from interested firms. Brief summary of tender is given below:
Tender No.: 11/2026-27/EE(C)/Pashulok Barrage
Name of work/supply/services etc: Manpower Service work for a Period of One Year through Outsourcing for execution of office related works of the Office of Executive Engineer (Civil) Pashulok Barrage, Rishikesh.
Estimated cost : Rs.5,49,483.21 (excluding GST).
Date of availability of bid document on website: From 17:00 hrs of 28.07.2026.
Last date for submission of bids on website: Upto 17:00 hrs of 11.08.2026.
For fuller & further details, kindly visit e-procurement portal "http://uktenders.gov.in"
Executive Engineer (Civil) Pashulok Barrage, Rishikesh
"AVOID WASTEFUL USE OF ELECTRICITY"

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING ATTENDANCE OF DEFENDANT

See Section 82 Cr.P.C./ 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023
Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Suraj, S/o: Jitender, R/o: H.No. 41, Gali No. 3, Fauzi Chowk, Aman Vihar, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **E-FIR No. 08550/2022, U/s: 379/411 IPC, Police Station Aman Vihar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Suraj** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Suraj** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).
Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Suraj of Police Station Aman Vihar, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **30.09.2026**.
By Order
Ms. Shagun
Ld. JMFC, North-West,
1st Floor, Room No. 109
Rohini Courts, Delhi
DP/10247/RD/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING ATTENDANCE OF DEFENDANT

See Section 82 Cr.P.C./ 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023
Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Sumit@Aju, S/o: Ram Chand, R/o: H.No. 1006, Gali No. 15, L Block, Sangam Vihar, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No.394/2021, U/s: 379/411 IPC, Police Station Kashmere Gate, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Sumit@Aju** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Sumit@Aju** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).
Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Sumit@Aju of Police Station Kashmere Gate, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **30.09.2026**.
By Order
Sh. Vaibhav Garg
JMFC-11, Central, 1st Floor, Room No. 138
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi
DP/9896/N/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.
Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused person Namely **Salman @ Kaliya S/o Asgar, R/o H. No - 298, Gali No - 02, E- Block, Shri Ram Colony Khajuri Khas Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 741/2020 U/s 25 A. Act PS: Khajuri Khas Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Salman @ Kaliya** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Salman @ Kaliya** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).
Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Salman @ Kaliya** accused of **FIR No. 741/2020 U/s 25 A. Act PS: Khajuri Khas Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **27.08.2026**.
By Order
Ms. Shruti Saraswat
DP/10318/NE/2026 JMFC- 03, Room No. 22,1st Floor
(Court Matter) Karkardooma Court, Delhi

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.
Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused person Namely **Gufrean S/o Md. Jahangir R/o C-1104, JJ. Colony, Bawana Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 668/22 U/s 356/379/411/34 IPC PS: Bawana, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Gufrean** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Gufrean** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).
Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Gufrean** accused of **FIR No. 668/22 U/s 356/379/411/34 IPC PS: Bawana, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **11.09.2026**.
By Order
Ms. Bharti Beniwal
JMFC-05, Room No. 114
Rohini Court, Delhi
DP/10090/ON/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82(2)(ii)Cr.P.C.
Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Person namely **Jumman@Monu S/o Mufijul@Rehman, R/o:H. No. L-369, Laxman Puri Chowk, Paharganj, New Delhi** (or is suspected to has committed) the offence in **FIR No. 60/2016, U/s 356/379/511/34 IPC**, registered at P.S.: Rajinder Nagar, Delhi and the warrant has been returned writing upon that the said accused **Jumman@Monu** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Jumman@Monu** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).
Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Jumman@Monu** accused **FIR No. 60/2016, U/s 356/379/511/34 IPC**, registered at P.S.: Rajinder Nagar, Delhi is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **29.08.2026**.
By Order
Ms. Preeti
Judicial Magistrate First Class
(Mahila Court)-01
Room No. 3, Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi
DP/10274/CD/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C./84 BNSS
Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Person namely **Neeraj S/o Sh. Deepak, R/o: P-31, Room No. 48, 5th floor, Pillanji Village, Sarojini Nagar, New Delhi** (or is suspected to has committed) the offence in **FIR No. 431/2023, U/s 380/411 IPC**, registered at P.S.: Sarojini Nagar, New Delhi and the warrant has been returned writing upon that the said accused **Neeraj** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Neeraj** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).
Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Neeraj** accused **FIR No. 431/2023, U/s 380/411 IPC**, registered at P.S.: Sarojini Nagar, New Delhi is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **31.08.2026**.
By Order
Ms. Vijayshree Rathore
Judicial Magistrate First Class-05
Room No. 13,
Patiala House Courts, New Delhi
DP/10229/SW/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023
Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused **Md. Jbran, S/o.Md. Anwarul Haque R/o. A-277, JJ Colony, Bawana, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in a case vide **FIR No.394/2023 U/S 3/181/5/18 AND 146/196 MV ACT** registered at **P.S Bawana, Outer North District, Delhi** and it has been returned on a warrant of arrest there upon issued stating that the said accused **Md. Jbran** could not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that accused **Md. Jbran** is absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).
Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Md. Jbran**, accused of **FIR No.394/2023 U/S 3/181/5/18 AND 146/196 MV ACT, P.S Bawana, Outer North District, Delhi** is required to appear before the court to answer the said complaint on or before **12.10.2026**.
By Order, Ms. Bharti Beniwal
Judicial Magistrate First Class-05 (North)
Court No. 114, First Floor,
Rohini Courts, Delhi
DP/10322/ON/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr. P.C & 84 BNSS
Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Person(s) **Jeeshan, S/o: Altaf R/o: H.No. 3910 Gali Jagat Cinema Wali Jama Masjid, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 213/2024, U/s: 379/411/IPC, PS: Darya Ganj, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **Jeeshan**, cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **Jeeshan**, has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).
Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person(s) **Jeeshan**, of **FIR No. 213/2024, U/s: 379/411/IPC, PS: Darya Ganj, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **29.08.2026**.
By Order
Dr. Raj Kumar Singh
Judicial Magistrate First Class-05 (Central)
Room No.241
Tis Hazari Court, Delhi
DP/9072/CD/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(SEE SECTION 82(2)(ii) Cr.P.C.)
Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person(s) **Karan Malhotra R/o Proprietor of Rozy Dry Cleaner at 26, Bhagwati Market, Bank Street, Karol Bagh, New Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No./Ct. Case No. 3738/2019, PS Shakarpur, East Distt., Delhi** and it has been returned to a Warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **Karan Malhotra** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **Karan Malhotra** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).
Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person(s) **Karan Malhotra** of case **FIR No./Ct. Case No. 3738/2019, PS Shakarpur, East Distt., Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before dated **19.11.2026 at 10:00 AM**.
By Order
Sh. Sachin
Judicial Magistrate First Class-03
Court No. 16, Shahdara Distt, (East)
Karkardooma Courts, Delhi
DP/10067/ED/2026
(Court Matter)

UNION TERRITORY OF JAMMU & KASHMIR
OOFFICE THE SUPERINTENDING ENGINEER PWD(R&B)CIRCLE SOUTH JAMMU
NOTICE INVITING TENDER
e-NIT No.SESJ/01 of 2026-27 dated 13-04-2026.
Fresh Short Term e-NIT No.SESJ/16 of 2026-27 dated 25-07-2026.

For and on behalf of the Lt. Governor of Union Territory of J&K, e-tenders are invited on **percentage rate basis** from approved and eligible Contractors registered with **Union Territory of J&K/CPWD / BRO/ Railways/ MES and other State/ Central Government** for the work mentioned below:-

S. No	Name of Work	Name of Division	Advertised Cost (Rs. Lakh)	Cost of document (in Rs.)	Earnest Money (in Rs.)	Time Allowed for completion	Time and date of opening of tender	Class of Contractor
1	Upgradation of Road from 4th bridge to Badarkali temple. (Under Pathholes for the year 2025-2026).	PWD (R&B) Division Satwari	203.00	3000	406000/- (2% of the Advertised Cost)	12 Months	(1400 Hrs) on or after 04-08-2026	"A" Class

Position of AAA = Accredited
Position of Tech. sanction = Accredited
The Bidding documents Consist of qualifying information, eligibility criteria, specifications, bill of quantities (B.O.Q), Set of terms and conditions of contract and other details can be seen/downloaded from the departmental website <http://iktenders.gov.in> as per below schedule:-

1	Date of Issue of Tender Notice	25-07-2026
2	Period of downloading of bidding documents	From 25-07-2026 to 03-08-2026, 1800 Hrs
3	Date, Time and place of pre-bid meeting	27-07-2026 at 1400 hours in the Office of the Superintending Engineer PWD (R&B)Circle South, Jammu.
4	Bid submission Start Date	25-07-2026 From 1800 Hrs
5	Bid Submission End Date	03-08-2026 up to 1800 Hrs
6	Date & time of opening of Technical Bids (Online)	04-08-2026 at 1400 hours in the Office of the Superintending Engineer PWD (R&B)Circle South, Jammu
7	Date & time of opening of Financial Bids	To be notified after technical bid evaluation is completed

1. Bids must be accompanied with cost of Tender document in shape of e-challan through Treasury indicating Treasury Voucher No. & date, e-NIT No. and name of work/bid crediting to 0059 (Revenue) favoring Superintending Engineer PWD(R&B)Circle South, Jammu and upload the same. The treasury challan/ receipt, Earnest money/ Bid security in shape of CDR/FDR/BC pledged to Superintending Engineer PWD(R&B)Circle South Jammu. The CDR/FDR/BC shall be valid for 45 Days beyond the bid validity period. The original instruments in respect of cost of documents, EMD and relevant documents of L1 be submitted to the Superintending Engineer PWD (R&B)Circle South Jammu at the time of allotment.
2. The electronic bidding system would not allow any late submission of bids after due date and time as per server time. Bidders may modify their bids by uploading their request for modification before the deadline for submission of bids. For this, the bidders need not to make any additional payment towards the cost of tender document. For bid modification and consequential re-submission, the bidder is not required to withdraw his bid submitted earlier. The last modified bid submitted by the bidder within the bid submission time shall be considered as the bid. For this purpose, modification/ withdrawal by other means will not be accepted. In online system of bid submission, the modification and consequential- submission of bids is allowed any number of times. The bidders may withdraw his bid by uploading their request before the deadline for submission of bids; however, if the bid is withdrawn, the re-submission of the bid is not allowed. No bid shall be modified or withdrawn after the deadline of submission of bids.
3. The date and time of opening of Financial-Bids shall be notified on Web Site www.iktenders.gov.in and conveyed to the bidders automatically through an e-mail message on their e-mail address. The Financial-bids of responsive bidders shall be opened online in the Office of Superintending Engineer PWD (R&B)Circle South Jammu. The date for same shall be intimated separately.
4. The bids for the work shall remain valid for a period of 120 days from the date of opening of Technical bids.
5 The earnest money shall be forfeited, if :-
a) Any bidder/tenderer withdraws his bid/tender during the period of bid validity or makes any modifications in the terms and conditions of the bid.
b) Failure of Successful bidder to furnish the required performance security within specified time period after issue of letter of acceptance.
c) Failure of successful bidder to execute the agreement on same day of allotment of work contract as per Chief Engineer PW (R&B) Department Jammu's Circular No. CEJ/G/12660-87 dated 07-10-2021.
6. Instruction to bidders regarding e-tendering process.
6.1. Bidders are advised to download bid submission manual from the "Downloads" option as well as from "Bidders Manual Kit" on website www.iktenders.gov.in to acquaint bid submission process.
6.2. To participate in bidding process, bidders have to get "Digital Signature Certificate [DSC]" as per Information Technology Act-2000. Bidders can get digital certificate from any approved vendors.
6.3. The bidders have to submit their bids online in electronic format with digital Signature. No financial bid will be accepted in physical form.
6.4. Bids will be opened online as per time schedule mentioned above.
6.5. Bidders must ensure to upload scanned copy of all necessary documents mentioned in NIT and SBD with technical bid online.
No.-SESJ/DB/4085-92
Dated:- 25-07-2026
DIP No:DIP/J-6759/26
Sd/-
Superintending Engineer
PWD (R&B)Circle South
Jammu

SHEHNAAZ SHARES WHY BOLLYWOOD OFFERS DRIED UP

Gill marked her Bollywood debut with 'Kisi Ka Bhai Kisi Ki Jaan', starring Bollywood star Salman Khan

Shehnaaz Gill marked her Bollywood debut with 'Kisi Ka Bhai Kisi Ki Jaan', starring Salman Khan. She also did 'Thank You for Coming' in the same year. Now, the actress opened up on why her Bollywood offers started drying up. She also got candid about her career choices and why she has been leaning more towards Punjabi cinema.

In an interview with 'News18', explaining the shift, Shehnaaz said, "In Punjabi films, the options for me are more. I won't say that I don't get as many offers from Bollywood, but I've become a star in the Punjabi film industry. And that's the honest truth. It's rightly said that log chhadte suraj ko salaam karte hai."

"All film industries function that way. If you're popular, people will come to you and want to cast you in their films. Main toh beautiful hoon hi aur actor bhi achchi hoon. I get a greater number of lead roles in Punjabi films. The other reason is that there are very few women actors there," she added.

Even in Punjabi cinema, Gill revealed she had to be selective. She said, "I've been getting a lot of offers from Punjabi filmmakers in the past five-six years, but I wasn't getting excited by most of the scripts. Most

of them required me not to do any heavy lifting. All I had to do was smile and laugh. I just want to do good, meaningful work. But thankfully, I got 'Ishqnama'."

Speaking about her approach to Hindi films, Shehnaaz said, "When it comes to Bollywood too, I'll do a film only if I have a role that leaves an impact. Otherwise, koi matlab nahi hai. Cinema aisi cheez hai jahaan aap chhup jaate ho saari umar ke liye. And the only way to be remembered is when you do good work."

She further explained, "It's not like I want to appear in every scene throughout the length of the film. But I want my character to be pivotal to the story, a character who can drive the story forward. If I get such roles in Hindi films, I'll definitely do it."

Shehnaaz also revealed she wants to avoid being reduced to glamour roles. "I don't want to be in a film only for glamour. I don't want to be used as a prop. I don't want to just be a heroine who appears in three odd songs in a film," she said.

The actress added that she now wants to follow in Radhika Apte's footsteps.



'I have become star in the Punjabi film industry,' says the actress

Kriti celebrates 5 years of 'Mimi'

Sanon had won a National Award for her performance in the film

Kriti Sanon turned nostalgic as her critically acclaimed film 'Mimi' completed five years since its release on July 26, 2021. The actress, who went on to win the National Award for her performance in the film, marked the milestone by sharing fan-made videos and throwback moments from the film on social media.

Kriti reposted a collage featuring several memorable stills from the film, capturing the emotional, comic and heartwarming moments from her performance as Mimi. The artwork read, "Mimi Completed 5 Years," along with the message, "5 Years of Laughter, Tears, Strength & Inspiration. Mimi will always stay in our hearts."

In another post, Kriti shared a video of herself walking up to receive her National Award for the film, writing, "5 years to Mimi. Thank you for all the love."

Directed by Laxman Utekar, 'Mimi' released on July 27, 2021. The film starred Kriti Sanon in the titular role of an aspiring dancer who agrees to become a surrogate mother, only to face unexpected emotional and social challenges along the way. The film also featured Pankaj Tripathi, Sai Tamhankar, Manoj Pahwa and Supriya Pathak in key roles.

Kriti's performance in the film earned her the National Film Award for 'Best Actress' at the 69th National Film Awards.



PRIME VIDEO INDIA INKS MULTI-YEAR DEAL WITH 'CJ ENM'



OUR CORRESPONDENT

Prime Video India and Korean entertainment powerhouse 'CJ ENM' announced a multi-year distribution deal to significantly expand the streamer's K-content offering for Indian audiences. The collaboration will see a slate of 26 new titles from 'CJ ENM' being rolled out over the next two years, alongside popular titles from CJ ENM's existing content library. This collaboration is an extension of the existing global deal between 'Prime Video' and 'CJ ENM', further strengthening the association and serving as a testament to the growing popularity of K-content in India.

The deal, spanning 100+ titles over two years, further underscores Prime Video's commitment to making entertainment borderless by providing a gateway for Korean content in India. All new and upcoming titles under the deal will feature subtitles in English and dubbing in Hindi, Tamil and Telugu.

"Building on our strong global relationship with 'CJ ENM' and the deal announced last year, we're excited to deepen this collaboration with a sharper focus on India. The popularity of Korean content has been remarkable across our Prime Video markets. Compelling narratives, diverse genres and memorable characters that transcend borders have fueled a K-content wave that continues to gain momentum year on year. By bringing a curated slate of premium Korean titles to 'Prime Video', we're doubling down on our commitment to making the most innovative and captivating stories

from Korea accessible to audiences in India," said Shilangi Mukherji, director and head, SVOD business, 'Prime Video India'.

The slate kicks off with 'Yumi's Cells' S3, the latest instalment of CJ ENM's flagship franchise that topped streaming charts in 81 countries, including the USA, Brazil, France and the UAE. The pipeline also includes globally celebrated hits such as 'Filing for Love', which ranked No. 1 in 105 countries; the breakout series 'The Legend of Kitchen Soldier', which captivated global audiences with its innovative production; and the romantic comedy 'My Bias, My Boss', among others. Also, as part of the offering are library titles such as 'Dear X', 'Law in the City', 'Study Group', 'My Dearest Nemesis', 'Search: WWW' and 'Yumi's Cells' seasons one and two, to name a few. Featuring acclaimed talent including Kim You-Jung, Lee Jong-suk, Park Ji-hoon and Cha Woo-min, these titles are backed by compelling storytelling across a diverse range of genres - drama, thriller, romance, fantasy and action - that have captivated audiences worldwide.

Jangho Seo, EVP of Platform Division at 'CJ ENM', said, "We are pleased to collaborate with 'Prime Video India' to bring CJ ENM's acclaimed K-dramas to a wider audience in one of the world's most dynamic entertainment markets. This partnership reflects our ongoing commitment to expanding the global reach of Korean storytelling."

This collaboration represents the latest investment in Prime Video's growing slate of Korean content.

The deal will give 'Prime' customers across India access to an array of shows, including 26 new titles from acclaimed K-content studio



SAN DIEGO COMIC-CON 2026

'Ramayana Pt 1 to end on a cliffhanger'

The film will be globally distributed by 'Sony Pictures Entertainment'

NEW DELHI: 'Ramayana' is a story that deserves to be told in two parts and the first one will end on a cliffhanger, said filmmaker Nitesh Tiwari, who attended the San Diego Comic Con with actors Ranbir Kapoor and Yash to promote the upcoming mythological drama.

The filmmaker attended the panel discussion at San Diego Comic-Con alongside Kapoor and Yash and producer Namit Malhotra on July 23.

"Where we leave in part 1, it is something which is called a cliffhanger. Something which will make people watch part 2 when they leave

Filmmaker Nitesh Tiwari said 'Ramayana' is a story that deserves to be told in two parts

we can leave it for part 2," the 'Dangal' director said.

Kapoor essays the role of Lord Ram in the film, whereas Yash will feature as Ravana. Actor Sai Pallavi essays the role of Sita, while Sunny Deol is Hanuman.

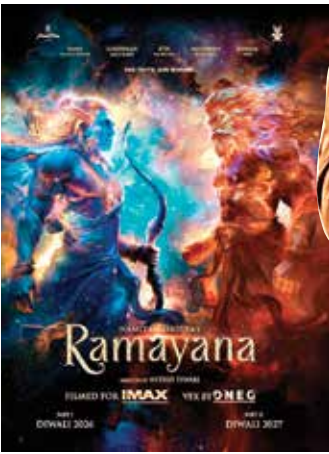
The film will be released in two parts, with the first instalment slated to arrive in theatres during Diwali 2026. The movie also features Ravi Dubey, Vivek Oberoi and Arun Govil among others. Reportedly made on a budget of Rs 4000 crore, the film will be globally distributed by 'Sony Pictures Entertainment'.

Yash opens up about 'pressure' of playing Ravana in 'Ramayana'

'I have given a different take on it,' says the 'Toxic: A Fairytale for Grown-Ups' star

The promotional campaign for Nitesh Tiwari's much-awaited 'Ramayana' kicked off in the US over the weekend, with the film's cast and makers attending San Diego Comic-Con for a panel discussion and select interviews. During the event, Yash, who plays Ravana, spoke candidly about stepping into a role that has been portrayed by countless actors over the decades.

In an interview with IGN, Yash joined co-star Ranbir Kapoor, director Nitesh Tiwari and producer Namit Malhotra. Speaking about taking on Ravana, he said, "As a kid, we have all heard this story. It's probably the first story I have heard. My grandfather used to tell me these stories. You have your imagination and you have seen so many people depict this in many ways. So, what do you bring in as an actor and what is your understanding of the character that was challenging? Thankfully, my director and writers have given me that space so I could play this character in a different way."



Yash also admitted that the weight of previous portrayals added pressure to his performance.

"If you know the character and everybody is aware of it, then it becomes challenging. If it's a new film where you are telling a new story, then whatever you do, that will become the character," he shared.



The film also stars Ranbir Kapoor, Sai Pallavi, Sunny Deol and many more